



CITY: Pg 3

Rekha Gupta leads 'Metro Monday' fuel-saving drive



WORLD: Pg 9

I will return with my head held high: Hasina



FILM: Pg 12

Huma gets candid about her Cannes dreams

CASE CLOSED

\$293 mn settlements: US Justice Dept drops all charges against Adani

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI/ NEW YORK: The US Department of Justice has permanently dropped criminal charges against Indian billionaire Gautam Adani and his nephew Sagar Adani, closing a high-profile fraud case in New York and marking the end of a string of US regulatory actions against the Adani Group that together resulted in settlements of USD 293 million.

In a filing before the United States District Court for the Eastern District of New York, the Justice Department asked for the indictment against the Adanis and other named defendants to be dismissed with prejudice, meaning the case cannot be reopened.

"The Department of Justice has reviewed this case and has decided, in its prosecutorial discretion, not to devote further resources to these criminal charges against individual defendants," prosecutors said in the filing.

The court subsequently ordered the dismissal. **Continued on P4**

Heatwave: No relief till May 24

INTENSE HEATWAVE GRIPS NORTH AND CENTRAL INDIA AS TEMPERATURES NEAR 47°C

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Large parts of north-west and central India are set to face a prolonged spell of high temperatures this week, with the mercury already nearing 45 degrees Celsius in several locations on Monday. The India Meteorological Department has warned that heatwave conditions will persist across multiple states until May 24, with some areas likely to see even more severe conditions in the coming days.

According to the weather office, isolated pockets of Punjab, Haryana, Rajasthan and Delhi are expected to experience heatwave conditions through the week. In Uttar Pradesh, both western and eastern regions may see heatwave to severe heatwave conditions starting Tuesday. Similar conditions are also likely across parts of Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Vidarbha and Marathwada during different days in the same period. Isolated areas in Bihar, Telangana, Coastal Andhra Pradesh and Yanam



A woman covers herself and a child on a hot summer day, in Rishikesh, Uttar Pradesh, on Monday

» HEALTH MINISTRY ADVISES FLUIDS, LIGHT CLOTHING, AND AVOIDING AFTERNOON SUN EXPOSURE

are also expected to be affected.

Temperatures have already climbed sharply across several regions. In Punjab, Bathinda recorded a high of 47 degrees Cel-

sus, among the highest in the country. In neighbouring Haryana, Sirsa registered 46.2 degrees Celsius. Other parts of Haryana also saw high temperatures, with Rohtak at

CLOSER LOOK

- » Northwesterly winds from Thar Desert and central Pakistan are driving Delhi's intense heat
- » Uttar Pradesh faces severe heatwave conditions from Tuesday through May 24
- » Northwest India temperatures to rise 2-3°C more; Chhattisgarh may see 3-4°C rise
- » Bihar, Telangana, Coastal Andhra Pradesh and Yanam also under heatwave watch
- » Himachal Pradesh gets wet spell forecast from May 19-24 with thunderstorm warnings
- » Rajasthan expects dry weather all week; dusty winds at 20-30 kmph likely

Continued on P4

India and Norway forge green alliance on energy, maritime & Arctic co-op



Prime Minister Narendra Modi receives the Grand Cross of the Royal Norwegian Order of Merit from King Harald V, in Oslo on Monday ANI

Receives Norway's highest civilian honour

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

HIGHLIGHTS

NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Monday elevated India's relationship with Norway to a "Green Strategic Partnership" after wide-ranging talks with Norwegian Prime Minister Jonas Gahr Store, as the two countries expanded cooperation across clean energy, maritime sectors, digital technology, space, health, and Arctic research, while also calling for peaceful resolution of global conflicts through dialogue and diplomacy. Modi's visit also saw Norway joining the India-led Indo-Pacific Oceans Initiative, multiple agreements being signed, and the Indian prime minis-

- » Modi-Store talks focused on clean energy, climate, maritime cooperation, digital tech, space, health, and Arctic research
- » Target set to double India-Norway trade by 2030

ter receiving Norway's highest civilian honour for foreign heads of government.

Addressing a joint media interaction in Oslo after delegation-level talks, Modi said India and Norway shared a common belief in a rules-based international order and peaceful engagement.

Continued on P4

CBI arrests Latur-based coaching centre founder in NEET-UG paper leak case

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: The Central Bureau of Investigation on Sunday arrested the owner of a coaching institute in Maharashtra's Latur district, bringing the total number of people held in the NEET-UG 2026 paper leak case to ten.

Shivraj Raghunath Motegaonkar, who runs Renukai Chemistry Classes (RCC) with nine branches across the region, was taken into custody after investigators found a leaked copy of the NEET-UG question paper on his mobile phone during searches at his premises. The examination had been held on May 3.

According to CBI officials, Motegaonkar received the question paper and its answers on April 23, nearly ten days before the exam was conducted across 551 Indian cities and 14 overseas centres, where close to 23 lakh candidates had registered to appear.

"He is close to P V Kulkarni, chemistry lecturer, who is associated with the NTA. Searches



The Rouse Avenue Court grants nine days of custody of the accused Shivraj Raghunath Motegaonkar to the CBI in the alleged NEET-UG paper leak case, in New Delhi on Monday

CLOSER LOOK

- » Parliamentary panel summons NTA chief; to review reforms, NEET-UG paper leak case on Thursday
- » Court sends coaching centre founder to 9-day CBI custody

conducted at his institute and residence resulted in the recovery of the chemistry question bank, which contained exactly the same

Continued on P4

Centre amends Citizenship Rules, 2009, adds passport surrender clause for eligible migrants

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: India has tightened documentation requirements for certain citizenship applicants, mandating fresh declarations on passport status for nationals of Pakistan, Afghanistan and Bangladesh applying under the Citizenship Rules, 2009.

In a notification issued on

Monday, the Union Home Ministry amended the 2009 rules to require applicants from these three countries to declare that they do not possess a valid or expired passport issued by their home governments.

If an applicant still holds an active passport, they must provide details including the passport number, date of issue, place of issuance and

expiry date, according to the gazette notification.

The amended rules also require applicants to declare that any valid or expired passport in their possession will be surrendered to the concerned Senior Superintendent of Post or Superintendent of Post within 15 days of their citizenship application being approved.

The new provision has been added after Schedule IC of the Citizenship Rules, which applies to Afghan, Bangladeshi and Pakistani nationals from Hindu, Sikh, Buddhist, Jain, Parsi and Christian communities seeking Indian citizenship.

The change is linked to the framework created by the Citizenship

Continued on P4

20-MEMBER CABINET SWORN IN

VD Satheesan takes oath as Kerala CM



Free KSRTC travel for women from June 15

MPOST BUREAU

THIRUVANANTHAPURAM: Vadasseri Damodara Menon Satheesan, who steered the Congress-led United Democratic Front (UDF) back to power in Kerala after a decade by unseating the Left Front, took oath as chief minister on Monday at a packed and politically charged ceremony held at the Central Stadium here.

His 20-member Cabinet, featuring a mix of experienced leaders and new entrants, was also sworn in

by Governor Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar, with senior Congress leader Ramesh Chennithala—once seen as a contender for the top post—among those inducted.

Satheesan was chosen by the Congress 10 days after the Kerala election results were declared. Congress chief Mallikarjun Kharge and senior party leaders Rahul Gandhi and Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, who represents Wayanad in parliament, among others, attended the swearing-in ceremony.

Continued on P4

Three road accidents in a day leave 30 dead

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: At least 30 people were killed and dozens injured in three separate road accidents across Uttar Pradesh, Maharashtra and Bihar on Monday, turning routine journeys and a family celebration into tragedies. The crashes involved head-on collisions between passenger

vehicles and heavy trucks or trailers, with officials pointing to factors such as speeding, overcrowding and loss of vehicle control. Prime Minister Narendra Modi, President Droupadi Murmu, and chief ministers in the affected states expressed grief, while compensation was announced for the families of the dead and support

Continued on P4

BAIL IS RULE, JAIL EXCEPTION EVEN IN UAPA CASES

SC questions its January verdict denying bail to Umar Khalid, Sharjeel Imam in Delhi riots case

Flags low conviction in UAPA cases, says 90% trials culminate in acquittals

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Monday raised concerns over its earlier approach to bail under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA), underlining that the principle "bail is the rule and jail is the exception" remains central even in cases involving serious charges. The court's observations came while granting bail to Jammu and Kashmir resident Syed Iftikhar Andrabi in a narco-terror case investigated by the National Investigation Agency (NIA), and while questioning aspects of its January 5 judgment that had denied bail to activists Umar



Khalid and Sharjeel Imam in the Delhi riots conspiracy case.

A bench of Justices B V Nagarathna and Ujjal Bhuyan said it had "serious reservations" about the reasoning adopted in the earlier judg-

TAKEAWAYS

- » The bench questioned the earlier order's direction preventing the accused from seeking fresh bail for one year
- » The court said Section 43D(5) of the UAPA cannot be used to justify indefinite detention and must remain subject to Articles 21 and 22 of the Constitution

ment. The January 5 ruling, delivered by a separate bench, had refused bail to Khalid and Imam and directed them to seek fresh bail after a year following examination of protected witnesses. Justice

Bhuyan, in Monday's order, pointed to concerns with such a restriction, noting that it effectively curtailed the right of the accused to seek bail within that period.

The court stressed that the principle governing bail is not merely a statutory phrase but a constitutional doctrine rooted in Articles 21 and 22, which safeguard personal liberty and due process. It said that the presumption of innocence remains a foundational aspect of the legal system and must guide decisions on detention and release.

"It is a constitutional principle flowing from Articles 21 and 22 and the

Continued on P4

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SIT PROBES DOWRY DEATH

Claims in husband’s bail plea add new twist to Twisha Sharma case

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NOIDA/BHOPAL: The alleged dowry death case of a 33-year-old woman took a dramatic turn on Monday after the contents of the bail application filed for her lawyer husband surfaced on social media, claiming that she was “a drug addict undergoing psychiatric treatment”.

A local court, which earlier granted anticipatory bail to the victim’s mother-in-law, retired judge Giribala Singh, reserved its order on Monday regarding the bail plea of her absconding husband, Samarth Singh.

Twisha, who met Samarth Singh through a dating app in 2024 and married him in December 2025, was found hanging at her marital home in the Katara Hills area on May 12.

While her family claims she was murdered due to relentless dowry harassment, a Special Investigation Team (SIT) has been formed to probe the allegations.

Misrod Assistant Commissioner of Police (ACP) Rajneesh Kashyap, who is



Family members of Twisha Sharma, outside the district court

heading the SIT, stated that efforts are underway to trace Samarth Singh.

Kashyap said the preliminary post-mortem report received from AIIMS Bhopal indicated death due to “hanging suicide”.

He said action would be taken against the investigating officer if negligence was found in not sending the rope allegedly used in the hanging to AIIMS during the post-mortem examination.

Kashyap said, “In the bail petition, allegations regarding Twisha being a drug addict

have been mentioned, but we are strictly investigating the case according to the sections in the FIR.”

The bail application filed by Giribala Singh for her son before a district court alleged that Twisha was addicted to drugs and would become irritable and develop trembling hands when she did not have access to narcotic substances.

It also claimed that Twisha had been undergoing psychiatric treatment and counselling.

The application stated Twisha had travelled to Delhi by

KEY POINTS

» Kashyap said the preliminary post-mortem report received from AIIMS indicated death due to ‘hanging suicide’

» He said action would be taken against the investigating officer if negligence was found in not sending the rope allegedly used in the hanging to AIIMS

money online for her needs.

The application reportedly included transaction receipts ranging from Rs 5,000 to Rs 50,000 as supporting documents.

According to officials, the SIT will investigate allegations related to dowry harassment, physical assault and alleged attempts to destroy evidence after Sharma’s death.

On Sunday, the victim, Twisha Sharma’s grief-stricken family staged a protest outside Chief Minister Mohan Yadav’s residence, demanding a fresh post-mortem at AIIMS Delhi.

Her father, Navnidhi Sharma, alleged that the local investigation is deeply compromised and pointed out that his daughter’s body has been kept in the AIIMS Bhopal mortuary for five days because the family wants a second autopsy to be conducted at AIIMS Delhi.

According to the victim’s relatives, she wanted to leave Bhopal and return to Noida and had remained in touch with them till around 10 pm on the day of the incident.

Woman dies after fall from roof; husband, father-in-law nabbed

DIPIKA KIROLA

GREATER NOIDA: A 24-year-old woman allegedly died under suspicious circumstances after falling from the roof of her matrimonial home in Greater Noida’s Jalpura village on Sunday, triggering allegations of dowry harassment and murder against her husband and in-laws. Police have arrested the woman’s husband and father-in-law and launched an investigation into the case.

The deceased, identified as Deepika, had married Ritik, a resident of Jalpura village, on December 11, 2024. Her father, Sanjay Nagar alleged that his daughter was subjected to continuous mental and physical harassment over dowry demands ever since the marriage.

According to the complaint lodged by Nagar, the family had given substantial gifts during the wedding, including a Scorpio SUV and around Rs 12 lakh in cash during various ceremonies. However, Deepika’s husband and his family allegedly continued demanding a Toyota Fortuner SUV and Rs 51 lakh in cash.

Nagar said that on Sunday afternoon, Deepika called him in tears and told him that her in-laws were assault-

TAKEAWAYS

» The deceased, identified as Deepika, had married Ritik, a resident of Jalpura village, on Dec 11, 2024. Her father, Sanjay Nagar alleged that his daughter was subjected to continuous mental and physical harassment over dowry demands

» According to the complaint lodged by Nagar, the family had given substantial gifts during the wedding, including a Scorpio SUV and around



Rs 12 lakh in cash during various ceremonies

» However, Deepika’s husband and his family allegedly continued demanding a Toyota Fortuner SUV and Rs 51 lakh in cash

ing her again over dowry. He, along with a relative, rushed to her matrimonial home in an attempt to resolve the dispute. However, he alleged that the family members behaved aggressively during the visit.

A few hours after returning home, Nagar said he received a call informing him that Deepika had fallen from the roof and was being taken to a hospital. “When we reached Sharda Hospital, she had already died,” he said.

The woman’s family alleged that her body bore multiple injury marks, raising suspi-

cion that she may have been assaulted before her death. Relatives also questioned why she was taken to Sharda Hospital, nearly 20 km away, instead of a nearby private hospital located just a few kilometres from the house. Based on the complaint, police registered an FIR under sections related to dowry death, cruelty by husband or relatives, and the Dowry Prohibition Act. Deputy commissioner of police (Central Noida) Shailendra Kumar Singh said the body has been sent for postmortem examination and further investigation is underway.

Undertrial inmate attacked with sharp object

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: An undertrial prisoner lodged in Mandoli jail in northeast Delhi was allegedly attacked with a sharp object by three fellow inmates inside a punishment cell, official sources said on Monday.

The incident took place on the night of May 11 inside Jail number 11 of the Mandoli prison complex.

According to jail sources, the injured inmate, Hunny (25), is lodged in the jail in connection with an Arms Act case.

Hunny alleged that he was performing prayers inside his cell around 8 pm when three inmates allegedly surrounded him and started assaulting him.

The accused inmates allegedly had an ongoing dispute with Hunny. They allegedly attacked him with a sharp object, and he sustained injuries in his waist, left hand and thigh, he added.

Hearing the commotion, jail staff rushed to the spot and intervened, following which the injured inmate was rescued and taken to GTB Hospital for treatment.

Sources said police received information about the incident the same night, but the injured inmate’s statement could not be recorded immediately due to jail procedures. A police team later visited the jail on May 14 to record the statement. An FIR has been registered and further investigation is underway.

Quick-thinking driver steers DTC bus into divider to avoid mishap near Rajghat signal

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: A DTC bus driver averted a major accident near the Rajghat traffic signal in central Delhi on Sunday after the vehicle reportedly suffered a brake failure while travelling from Sarai Kale Khan towards Rajghat.

Police said a PCR call regarding the incident was received at the I.P Estate Police Station, following which local police and traffic personnel rushed to the spot near the Rajghat signal to assess the situation and regulate traffic movement.

“As per the police, the bus developed a technical fault in its braking system while travelling towards Rajghat”

During the preliminary inquiry, officials found that the bus was empty at the time of the incident, with only the driver and conductor on board.

According to police, the bus developed a technical fault in its braking system while travelling towards Rajghat. As the vehicle approached the traffic signal, the brakes allegedly failed, creating a potentially dangerous situation on the

busy stretch.

However, the driver acted swiftly and steered the bus into a road divider to slow down and bring the vehicle to a halt safely, preventing a possible collision with other vehicles or pedestrians near the intersection.

The bus eventually stopped after mounting the divider, averting what could have turned into a major accident in the high-traffic area.

Wanted criminal who chopped off man’s thumbs arrested after 6 years on the run

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A 70-year-old man accused of chopping off both thumbs of an event manager during a brutal robbery and extortion attempt in Delhi’s Dwarka was arrested after evading capture for nearly six years, an official said on Monday.

The accused Brahamdev Bhagat -- declared a proclaimed offender -- was arrested from Bihar’s Purnia in connection with a 2020 case in which the victim was assaulted with sticks, robbed at knifepoint and forced to sign documents for an alleged pay-

Cops: Three co-accused had earlier been caught, but Bhagat remained absconding

ment of Rs 11 lakh before his thumbs were severed, police said. “The incident took place on March 17, 2020, when event manager Surinder Nanda received a call regarding a party booking and asked his manager Kapil Chadha to attend the meeting in Dwarka on his behalf,” Deputy Commissioner of Police (Crime Branch) Pankaj Kumar said in a statement.

Later, the callers insisted on meeting Nanda personally.

sign documents related to an alleged vegetable payment dispute,” the officer said.

Bhagat then attacked Nanda with a knife and chopped off both his thumbs before releasing him and Chadha. Nanda later reached DDU Hospital, following which a case was registered at Dwarka Sector-23 police station on March 18, 2020.

Three co-accused were arrested earlier, while Bhagat, declared a proclaimed offender in December 2025, was apprehended in Purnia after evading arrest by frequently changing locations, police said.

NIA files chargesheet in UP rly surveillance case

DIPIKA KIROLA

GHAZIABAD: The National Investigation Agency (NIA) on Monday chargesheeted five juveniles for allegedly assisting Pakistan-based terror operatives in installing spy cameras at sensitive railway locations in Uttar Pradesh, officials said.

The juveniles, classified as “children in conflict with law”, are among 21 accused arrested in the case, which was initially registered by Ghaziabad Police in March this year.

The NIA filed its report before the Juvenile Justice Board in Ghaziabad under provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), the Official Secrets Act and the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act.

According to the agency, the accused juveniles conspired with other suspects to assist Pakistan-based handlers

“Juveniles illegally accessed prohibited rly areas, helped install solar-powered spy cameras and transmitted geo-tagged visuals to handlers operating from Pakistan”

in collecting photographs, videos and GPS coordinates of strategically important railway installations, allegedly compromising national security.

Investigators said the juveniles illegally accessed prohibited railway areas, helped install solar-powered spy cameras and transmitted geo-tagged visuals to handlers operating from Pakistan. They are also accused of procuring Indian SIM cards allegedly used for terror-related activities within the country.

Officials said the spy cameras were mounted nearly 20 feet high on platform poles to capture multiple railway plat-

forms and monitor train movements. Investigators suspect the surveillance devices were intended to gather sensitive logistical and military-related information.

During the initial probe, Ghaziabad Police had claimed that the network planned to install similar spy cameras at nearly 50 more locations stretching from Delhi to Kashmir to monitor strategic movements and collect military intelligence. The NIA said further investigation into the role of the remaining accused and other suspects linked to the network is underway.

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The peak power demand in the national capital soared to 7,542 megawatts, the highest so far this summer, as the day temperature rose to 43.4 degrees Celsius on Monday.

Mercury is rising in the city with the progression of summer. The weather department has predicted the maximum temperature to rise further to 44 degrees Celsius on Tuesday. Realtime data from the State Load Dispatch Centre in Delhi showed the peak demand at 7,542 MW at 4.05 pm on Monday. The peak demand on Sunday was 7,094 MW.

This year, the peak power demand in Delhi is estimated to cross 9,000 MW.

The highest peak demand last year was recorded at 8,442 MW on June 12.



‘Power demand is estimated to cross 9,000 MW this yr’

The all-time high in peak power demand in the capital was 8,656 MW, recorded on June 19, 2024. Discoms say the rise in power demand in summer is pushed up primarily by enhanced use of coolers, air conditioners and refrigeration appliances.

Sirsa inaugurates Rs 7.5 crore infra projs in Rajouri Garden

Upgraded parks and community facilities planned

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Delhi Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa on Monday inaugurated infrastructure projects worth around Rs 7.5 crore in the Rajouri Garden assembly constituency, including road construction, sewage and water pipeline works, and renovation of parks and a community centre.

Sirsa, who holds the industries, food and supplies, environment, forest and wildlife portfolios in the Delhi government, said the projects would improve road connectivity, sanitation and water infrastructure in the area. According to a statement issued by the Delhi government, the works include construction of a ready-mix concrete (RMC) road, sewage



“The projects were aligned with the government’s vision of building a Viksit Delhi”

and water pipeline projects, and renovation of one community centre and five public parks.

“Infrastructure works worth around Rs 7.5 crore will create an atmosphere of cleanliness in the Rajouri Garden Assembly Constituency and further strengthen civic infrastructure,” he said. The minister also thanked Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta for allocating around Rs 100 crore for development works in Rajouri Garden. “This funding will be utilised for roads, sewage lines, water pipelines, street lighting, and several other infrastructure projects for the benefit of citizens,” Sirsa said.

He said the projects were aligned with the government’s vision of building a “Viksit Delhi” and reiterated the administration’s commitment towards strengthening urban infrastructure.

MINISTERS SWAP OFFICIAL CARS FOR METRO, FEEDER BUSES

Rekha Gupta leads ‘Metro Monday’ fuel-saving drive

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: In a significant push towards fuel conservation and sustainable urban mobility, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Monday led the Delhi Government’s “Metro Monday” initiative under the “Mera Bharat, Mera Yogdan” campaign by travelling through Delhi Metro and DTC feeder bus services to reach the Delhi Secretariat. Several Ministers, legislators and senior government officials also used public transport during the day in support of the initiative.

The campaign has been launched in line with the appeal made by Prime Minister Narendra Modi urging citizens to adopt fuel conservation measures, promote public transport usage and contribute towards environmental sustainability.

The Chief Minister commenced her journey by walking from her official residence, Mukhyamantri Jan Seva Sadan in Civil Lines, to Lok Niwas for a meeting chaired by Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu. Thereafter, she travelled from Kashmere Gate Metro Station to ITO Metro Station using Delhi Metro services and subsequently reached the Delhi Secretariat through a feeder bus service. Delhi Ministers Parvesh Sahib Singh and Ravinder Indraj Singh accompanied the Chief Minister during the journey.

Addressing the significance of the initiative, the CM stated, “The ‘Mera Bharat, Mera Yogdan’ campaign is not merely a government initiative, but a movement of public participation.”

She further said, “Even a small effort made in national interest plays an important role in strengthening the country’s energy security, environmental protection and economic balance.” Transport Minister Pankaj Kumar Singh travelled from Vikaspuri to the Delhi Secretariat using Metro services and an electric DTC bus. During the journey, he interacted with commuters and directed officials to address suggestions related to passenger convenience.

“The Delhi Government is committed to making public transport more accessible, comfortable and environment-friendly,” he said.

Environment Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa also travelled by Metro from Rajouri Garden to Indraprastha Metro Station and thereafter used an EV DEVI bus to reach the Secretariat. “It is our duty to support the appeal made by the Hon’ble Prime Minister. Not only today, but we have also reduced the use of official vehicles,” Sirsa stated.

Labour Minister Kapil Mishra also travelled by Delhi Metro and Metro feeder bus as part of the initiative. He said, “Under the leadership of Hon’ble Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, the Delhi Government and the people of Delhi are fulfilling the ‘Mera Bharat–Mera Yogdan’ pledge inspired by the call of Prime Minister Narendra Modi ji.”

He further stated that Delhi residents, traders and industrialists were actively supporting the campaign through greater use of public transport, work-from-home arrangements, carpooling and electric vehicles.

Social Welfare Minister Ravinder Indraj Singh described the campaign as an important step towards responsible citizenship and appealed to residents to increasingly adopt public transport for fuel conservation, traffic management and environmental protection.



Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, centre, Minister’s Ravinder Indraj Singh, left, and Parvesh Sahib travels by DTC bus, in New Delhi, on Monday PFI

TAKEAWAYS

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- » Thereafter, she travelled from Kashmere Gate to ITO Metro Stn using Delhi Metro services and subsequently reached the Delhi Secretariat via a feeder bus service

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L-G Sandhu interacts with people during a ride in Delhi Metro PFI

“To ensure smoother travel and manage add’l passenger footfall, DMRC deployed six extra trains operating 24 add’l trips”

DMRC said, “Delhi Metro received an encouraging response today” under the “Metro Monday” initiative.

To ensure smoother travel and manage additional passenger footfall, DMRC deployed six extra trains operating 24 additional trips across the network. The corporation said this arrangement would continue every Monday and more services could be added on other days depending on demand.

“The additional services are aimed at providing safe, reliable, convenient and environment-friendly public transport while supporting the larger objective of fuel conservation and sustainable urban mobility,” DMRC stated.

Officials said the initiative forms part of a wider push by the Delhi Government to reduce dependence on fuel-driven private vehicles, improve environmental sustainability and ease congestion on city roads.

DMRC also said it would continue monitoring commuter patterns and passenger volumes in the coming weeks to assess whether further operational measures or additional services are required to support the campaign.

Over 63,000 households listed in NDMC & Cantt areas under 1st phase of Census 2027

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Over 63,000 households and roughly 2.5 lakh persons were enumerated in the Lytuens Delhi and Cantt areas during the ongoing Census 2027 exercise, officials said on Monday.

Under the Houselisting and Housing Operation phase of the Census, which was conducted from April 16 to May 15, enumerators reached out to over 63,000 households in NDMC and Delhi Cantt areas, covering around 2.5 lakh population.

More concrete data will emerge after completion of the second phase, they said.

The houselisting exercise was preceded by a self-enumeration phase on April 1-15



“More concrete data will emerge after completion of the second phase”

in which a few thousand people completed their household details. Census officials said that the New Delhi Municipal Corporation (NDMC) has a far larger floating population of around 10 lakh.

Currently, the houselisting exercise is underway in 250 wards of the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD), comprising the rest of the city. In the self-enumeration phase from May 1-15, 1.34 lakh persons submitted Census details online. Under the houselisting phase, around 50,000 enumerators will visit households in MCD wards, covering more than 46,000 houselisting blocks. The enumerators are carrying out a ground truthing exercise to check the maps provided to them.

There are around 30-32 lakh houses in MCD areas. The wards have been mapped into around 46,000 houselisting blocks, each comprising 180-200 houses, an official tasked with Census work said.

Census 2027 is underway in the country. The 16th census exercise is completely digital and will be completed in two phases. The Houselisting and Housing operations will continue in different parts of the country up to September.

The second and final phase of population enumeration is scheduled for February 2027.

Fire at house in Subhash Nagar; no injuries: DFS

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A fire broke out at a house in west Delhi’s Subhash Nagar area on Monday evening, an official of the Delhi Fire Service said.

No injuries were reported in the incident.

According to the DFS, the fire was reported from Block-2 of Subhash Nagar at 6.52 pm, following which two fire tenders were rushed to the spot.

The official said that the blaze was confined to household articles kept on the ground floor of the house.

Firefighters brought the situation under control within 15 to 20 minutes. The exact extent of damage caused in the incident is yet to be ascertained, he said.

SC seeks Delhi govt’s response on plea to make regular appointments in DERC

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court on Monday sought a response from the Delhi government on a plea seeking a direction to make regular appointments of the chairperson and members of the Delhi Electricity Regulatory Commission (DERC).

While agreeing to hear the plea, a bench of Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justice Joy-malya Bagchi said the counsel for the Delhi government may be ready with instructions on the issue on the next date of hearing.

The bench was hearing a plea filed by NGO Energy Watchdog, which referred to an August last year order of the apex court. In that order, the top court, while dealing with a separate petition, had recorded that the counsel appearing for the Delhi government assured that the process of regular appointments in the DERC would be completed expeditiously.

MAYOR PICKS UP GARBAGE; PUSHES CLEANLINESS DRIVE

Mayor inspects Karol Bagh sanitation works

ANAMTA FATIMA



NEW DELHI: Amid soaring temperatures in the Capital, Praveesh Wahi on Sunday carried out an extensive inspection of sanitation arrangements and civic infrastructure projects in the Karol Bagh Zone, directing officials to prioritise cleanliness and warning that negligence would not be tolerated.

Accompanied by local councillor Manish Chadha and senior officials of the Municipal Corporation of Delhi, the Mayor reviewed sanitation conditions in the Chuna Mandi area along Rajguru Road, one

“Wahi also reviewed dev works at the Panchkuian Road Crematorium, including the construction of a CNG platform”

of the city’s densely crowded commercial stretches. Interacting with residents and traders, Wahi appealed to citizens to dispose of waste only in designated bins and cooperate with civic authorities in maintaining public hygiene.

In a symbolic gesture aimed at promoting civic responsibility, the Mayor picked up garbage lying on the roadside and disposed of it in a dust-

bin before joining sanitation workers in sweeping parts of the locality. He stressed that public participation remained crucial for achieving the goal of a cleaner Delhi.

During the inspection, Wahi also reviewed development works at the Panchkuian Road Crematorium, including the construction of a CNG platform, and instructed officials to ensure timely completion

while maintaining quality standards. He later inspected the Fixed Compactor Transfer Station on Panchkuian Road and highlighted the Corporation’s efforts to modernise waste management through mechanised sweepers and litter-picking machines.

Earlier in the day, the Mayor travelled to the inspection site by Delhi Metro from R.K. Ashram Metro Station, backing Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s appeal for greater public transport use and supporting Delhi’s “Metro Monday” campaign aimed at reducing pollution and fuel consumption.

Delhi Metro deploys extra trains for ‘Metro Monday’

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: With Delhi Metro introducing six extra trains and 24 additional trips to handle rising commuter demand, the Delhi Government’s “Metro Monday” initiative received a strong response on Monday as ministers, MPs, officials and citizens chose public transport over private vehicles in support of fuel conservation and sustainable mobility.

According to Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC), the campaign was launched by the Delhi Government following the national appeal to conserve fuel amid recent developments in the Middle East. The initiative encourages residents to use metro and other public transport services every Monday instead of personal vehicles.

Several senior leaders travelled by metro during the day, including Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, Transport Minister Pankaj Kumar Singh, Environment Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa, Labour Minister Kapil Mishra and Education Minister Ashish Sood. Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister Mohan Yadav also travelled by metro as part of the campaign.

Govt distributing 25,000 ORS packets daily at Atal canteens

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government is distributing around 25,000 Oral Rehydration Solution (ORS) packets daily at Atal canteens and night shelters across the city in an effort to provide relief to people affected by the scorching summer heat.

The initiative, launched on May 15, aims to help people avoid dehydration and heat-stroke during the ongoing heat-wave conditions in the national capital. The drive will continue till July 15, an official said.

He said that ORS packets are being distributed during lunch hours at Atal canteens, where a large number of daily wage workers, homeless persons and economically weaker sections visit for subsidised meals. “During lunch hours alone, around 25,000 ORS packets are being distributed every day,” the official said.

According to him, the Delhi Urban Shelter Improvement Board (DUSIB) coordinated with the health department to procure ORS packets for the campaign. In the first phase, around four lakh ORS packets were supplied, followed by another six lakh in the second phase. “Overall, nearly 10 lakh ORS packets have been handed over to vendors operating Atal canteens and caretakers managing night shelters,” the official said, and added that all the ORS are of orange flavour so that people drink it more.

Apart from the distribution drive, authorities have also stepped up preparedness measures at night shelters to tackle heat-related emergencies. He said nearby hospitals have been identified for all 198 shelters operating under DUSIB, and hospital authorities have been informed to ensure timely medical assistance in case of emergencies.

Officials said posters displaying nearby hospital contacts, ambulance helpline numbers and DUSIB control room details have been installed at shelters along with Hindi advisories on heat precautions. Weekly inspections are also being conducted to ensure fans and coolers function properly, with agencies facing penalties for lapses. Delhi recorded a maximum temperature of 43.4 degrees Celsius on Monday.

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Capital to get major parking infra boost

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: In a major urban infrastructure push aimed at tackling chronic congestion and pollution, the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) has announced an ambitious expansion of parking infrastructure alongside an intensified anti-dust sanitation campaign in key parts of the Capital.

The civic body is planning nearly 50 surface parking facilities and multiple multi-level parking projects across some of Delhi’s busiest commercial and market zones, officials said. The proposal is expected to be placed before the upcoming House meeting of the corporation.

Among the most significant projects is a massive multi-level parking facility proposed near the Idgah Metro Station in the congested Sadar-Paharganj wholesale belt an area long plagued by chaotic roadside parking, traffic snarls and overcrowded market lanes. Spread across nearly 23,000 square metres, the ramp-based structure is expected to accommodate around 2,100 equivalent car spaces at an estimated cost of ₹346 crore, making it one of the city’s largest proposed parking infrastructures.

Dy Mayor pushes transparency in civic advertisement operations

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Deputy Mayor Dr Monica Pant on Monday chaired a review meeting with senior officials of the Municipal Corporation of Delhi’s advertisement department and stressed the need to strengthen transparency and boost civic revenue generation.

The meeting was attended by Additional Deputy Commissioner Sanjay Singh and other senior officials of the department.

Officials briefed the Deputy Mayor on the functioning of the department and ongoing projects related to civic advertisements across the city.

During the meeting, Dr Pant directed officials to strengthen monitoring and revenue collection mechanisms while ensuring transparency in departmental processes. She also emphasised the need to explore new sources of advertisement revenue for the civic body.

The Deputy Mayor suggested increasing the use of advertisements at subways, public toilets and other public facilities to improve public awareness campaigns

as well as revenue generation. She also asked officials to examine the commercial potential of self-signage systems and LED advertisements in market areas.

Officials were further directed to study the feasibility of advertisements in residential areas while ensuring compliance with civic norms and transparency in implementation.

Necessary directions were issued to streamline departmental operations and improve the management of advertisement-related activities across the Capital.

OVERTURNS ITS 2018 ORDER

‘BCCI not a public authority under RTI Act’: CIC

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The BCCI is not a public authority under the Right to Information Act, thus it is not liable to answer any queries under the transparency law, the Central Information Commission held on Monday, overturning its own 2018 order in this regard.

Information Commissioner P R Ramesh said that the Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI), despite performing important public functions relating to cricket administration and India's representation in international tournaments, cannot be treated as a public authority as it is neither owned, controlled, nor substantially

financed by the government.

“The BCCI cannot be classified as a ‘public authority’ within the meaning of Section 2(h) of the Right to Information (RTI) Act, and the provisions of the Act are therefore inapplicable to it in the facts and circumstances of the present case,” Ramesh said in the order, dismissing an appeal seeking information about the provisions and authority under which the BCCI represents India and selects players for national and international tournaments.

The current structure and functioning of the BCCI are broadly in line with other major cricket boards across the world, including those in England, Australia, South Africa, the West Indies

and Pakistan, which operate as autonomous or private bodies outside the direct ambit of transparency laws, though many voluntarily disclose financial and administrative information.

The ruling marked a reversal of a 2018 order of the then-information commissioner and a noted law professor, M Sridhar Acharyulu, who held BCCI to be a public authority and directed its president, secretary and committee of administrators to designate central public information officers, assistant public information officers and first appellate authorities under the RTI Act.

The Central Information Commission (CIC) had also directed the BCCI to proactively disclose information under Section 4 of the law and

furnish point-wise replies to the RTI applicant.

The BCCI, however, had challenged the 2018 order before the Madras High Court, which, in September 2025, remitted the matter back to the CIC for reconsideration in light of the Supreme Court's observations in the BCCI vs Cricket Association of Bihar case and said the Commission should pass fresh orders after re-examining the legal position.

Revisiting the issue, the CIC said that the BCCI is a private autonomous body registered under the Tamil Nadu Societies Registration Act, which was not established by the Constitution, Parliament, a state legislature or through a govt notification.

US industry delegation meets Jitendra Singh

Discusses private investment opportunities in India's nuclear sector

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A US industry delegation from the Nuclear Energy Institute (NEI) and the US-India Strategic Partnership Forum (USISPF) on Monday met Union Minister of State for Science and Technology Jitendra Singh to explore private investment opportunities in India's nuclear energy sector.

The discussions centred on India's Nuclear Energy Mission, recent policy reforms under the newly enacted SHANTI Act, 2025, and the expanding scope of India-US cooperation in clean and critical energy technologies.

Secretary, Department of Science and Technology, Rajesh S Gokhale, and senior officials from the Department of Atomic Energy also participated.

From Page 1

Heatwave

In Rajasthan, several cities crossed 45 degrees Celsius. Pilani and Chittorgarh both recorded 46.2 degrees Celsius, while Sri Ganganagar touched 46.1 degrees. Bikaner recorded 46 degrees Celsius, followed by Vanasthali at 45.6 degrees, Fatehpur at 45.5 degrees and Kota at 45.3 degrees. Barmer and Churu recorded 45.1 degrees each. Jaipur reported 43.6 degrees Celsius, with most cities in the state crossing 41 degrees.

The Meteorological Centre in Jaipur said the weather is likely to remain dry across Rajasthan through the week. Heatwave conditions are expected in border areas of western Rajasthan and parts of the south-eastern region. Strong dusty winds moving at speeds of 20 to 30 kilometres per hour are also expected across western, northern and eastern parts of the state over the next four to five days.

Delhi also experienced high temperatures, with some areas touching 44 degrees Celsius. The Safdarjung base station recorded a maximum temperature of 43.4 degrees Celsius. The Ridge station was the hottest at 44.6 degrees Celsius, while Lodhi Road recorded 43.8 degrees, which is 4.8 degrees above normal. This marked the hottest May day in the city in two years. Dry winds and intense heat made daytime conditions difficult for commuters in the national capital. Mahesh Palawat, vice president at Skymet Weather, said, “The northwesterly winds are sweeping into the national capital from the Thar Desert region of Rajasthan and parts of central Pakistan. Travelling across vast arid stretches, these winds turn intensely dry by the time they reach Delhi, trapping heat close to the surface and sharply intensifying the searing conditions across the city.”

He added that night temperatures have remained high due to strong daytime heating and said there is no forecast of thunderstorms or pre-monsoon rainfall activity over the next 10 days. For Tuesday, the IMD has issued a yellow alert for heatwave conditions in Delhi, with temperatures likely to touch 45 degrees Celsius over the next two days.

The rising temperatures have also pushed up electricity demand in the capital. Peak power demand reached 7,542 megawatts, the highest so far this summer. The all-time high for Delhi stands at 8,656 megawatts, recorded two years ago.

In Punjab and Haryana, Chandigarh recorded its hottest day of the season so far at 42 degrees Celsius. Faridkot registered 46.4 degrees Celsius, while Amritsar recorded 42 degrees, Ludhiana 42.2 degrees and Patiala 44 degrees.

In contrast, hill states have seen relatively moderate temperatures but are also witnessing a rise. Dharamshala recorded a maximum of 35 degrees Celsius, while Manali and Shimla reported 28.4 degrees and 28.2 degrees respectively. Kufri recorded 23.8 degrees. Una was the hottest in Himachal Pradesh at 39.7 degrees Celsius, while Kukumsari recorded the lowest night temperature at 4.3 degrees.

The Shimla meteorological office has forecast a wet spell in Himachal Pradesh from May 19 to 24. A yellow warning has been issued for thunderstorms, lightning and gusty winds of 30 to 40 kilometres per hour in parts of Chamba, Kangra and Kullu on May 21, and in Chamba, Kangra, Kullu and Mandi on May 22.

The IMD said maximum temperatures are expected to rise gradually by 2 to 3 degrees Celsius across many parts of northwest India until May 24. In Chhattisgarh, temperatures may rise by 3 to 4 degrees Celsius till May 21. Maharashtra and Gujarat are likely to see no major change until May 18, followed by a slight drop of 2 to 3 degrees between May 19 and

May 24. The rest of the country is expected to see no major change in temperatures during this period.

Amid the rising heat, the Directorate General of Health Services under the Union health ministry, in coordination with the Ayush ministry, has issued an advisory to help people cope with heat stress. The advisory recommends staying hydrated, avoiding direct sun exposure during afternoon hours, wearing light cotton clothing and consuming seasonal fruits and fluids rich in electrolytes.

It also advises precautions at workplaces and public spaces, including providing shaded rest areas, ensuring regular water breaks and raising awareness about signs of heat-related illness.

Adani

The decision brings to a close one of the most closely watched legal challenges faced by the Adani Group, whose international growth plans had come under pressure after US authorities launched parallel investigations in late 2024.

The criminal case had alleged that Gautam Adani and Sagar Adani were involved in misleading investors and lenders while capital was being raised for solar energy projects in India. Prosecutors had linked the matter to an alleged USD 265 million bribery scheme involving Indian officials to secure power contracts. However, people familiar with the matter said prosecutors ultimately concluded there were insufficient grounds to sustain the charges, particularly given the absence of clear US jurisdictional links.

The dismissal followed months of legal engagement by a large defence team representing the Adanis. Lawyers from Sullivan & Cromwell, Nixon Peabody, Hecker Fink, Norton Rose Fulbright and Bracewell made repeated submissions and presentations to US authorities during the review process. Earlier this month, the US Securities and Exchange Commission resolved related civil allegations involving disclosures made to investors connected with the Indian solar projects. Court filings showed Gautam Adani agreed to pay USD 6 million, while Sagar Adani agreed to pay USD 12 million. The settlement was reached without either man admitting or denying wrongdoing.

Separately, the US Treasury Department's Office of Foreign Assets Control settled allegations involving Adani Group's LPG imports linked to Iran sanctions compliance. The conglomerate agreed to pay USD 275 million after what authorities described as extensive cooperation and proactive disclosures.

The legal pushback by the Adanis had focused heavily on jurisdiction. In submissions made public on April 7, 2026, their lawyers argued that the SEC case represented an “impermissibly extraterritorial application” of US securities laws. The defence said the matter concerned “Indian Defendants, an Indian issuer” involving securities not traded on US exchanges and conduct that occurred “exclusively in India”.

The filings also argued the SEC lacked jurisdiction, had failed to establish actionable misstatements, and could not connect either Gautam or Sagar Adani directly to the bond offering. The defence maintained there were no investor losses, all bond obligations had been honoured, and Gautam Adani had not authorised the bond issuance.

Legal scrutiny had also grown over the structure of the prosecution. Gautam Adani, Sagar Adani and Vneet Jaan were charged only under securities and wire fraud statutes, specifically counts 2, 3 and 4. They were not charged under the Foreign Corrupt Practices Act bribery count or obstruction-related allegations, which were brought against other defendants.

That distinction became central to criticism of the government's approach. Former SEC commissioner Laura Unger argued regula-

tors were effectively trying to build a securities fraud case around bribery allegations that had neither been adjudicated nor formally pursued in India.

The Adani Group had consistently rejected the allegations, calling them baseless while defending its governance and compliance practices.

With the criminal indictment now permanently dismissed, a major legal overhang on the group has been lifted.

India, Norway

“India and Norway both believe in a rules-based order, dialogue, and diplomacy. We are in agreement that no issue can be resolved through military conflict,” Modi said.

Referring to the conflicts in Ukraine and West Asia, he said both countries supported efforts aimed at ending hostilities and restoring peace.

The talks marked a major step in bilateral ties, with both nations agreeing to establish a Green Strategic Partnership aimed at combining Norway's technology and investment strength with India's manufacturing scale and skilled workforce.

Modi said the framework would help companies from both countries develop solutions in clean energy, climate resilience, blue economy and green shipping, adding that the initiative would have wider global relevance.

The two sides also agreed to target a doubling of bilateral trade by 2030.

A major economic pillar of the discussions was the Trade and Economic Partnership Agreement between India and the European Free Trade Association. Modi described the pact as a roadmap for shared prosperity, noting that it is expected to bring USD 100 billion in investment into India and create one million jobs over the next 15 years.

The visit also delivered a series of sector-specific agreements.

In the space sector, the Indian Space Research Organisation and the Norwegian Space Agency signed a memorandum of understanding for peaceful cooperation in outer space.

Highlighting Arctic cooperation, Modi thanked Norway for supporting India's Arctic research station, Himadri. He said collaboration in polar research would help improve understanding of climate change and ecosystem protection.

Digital cooperation also moved forward through an India-Norway Digital Development Partnership, under which the two countries will work together on digital public infrastructure and digital transformation initiatives in developing countries, especially across the Global South.

Health cooperation was institutionalised through the creation of a Joint Working Group, while agreements were signed in science, innovation, and geotechnical engineering, including consultancy in tunnel development and slope stability for infrastructure projects.

Research cooperation was strengthened through agreements involving India's Council of Scientific and Industrial Research and Norway's SINTEF foundation, covering ocean energy, biomaterials, carbon capture, offshore wind, wave energy, geosciences, and academic mobility.

Maritime cooperation emerged as another major focus.

With Norway joining the Indo-Pacific Oceans Initiative, the two countries agreed to deepen work in marine economy, maritime security, ship-building, green shipping, port infrastructure, and capacity building.

“As two major maritime nations, we will work together to strengthen cooperation in the marine economy, maritime security, and capacity building,” Modi said.

The leaders also discussed defence cooperation and defence industrial collaboration, identifying

potential for stronger engagement in the sector.

Modi said the two sides would also expand cooperation in sustainability, geology, health, skill development, and talent mobility, while linking universities and startup ecosystems in engineering, artificial intelligence, cyber security, and digital technologies.

The leaders also addressed global political challenges, including terrorism.

A joint statement said both prime ministers “unequivocally and strongly condemned terrorism and violent extremism in all its forms and manifestations, including cross-border terrorism.”

The statement called for dismantling terror infrastructure and safe havens, and stronger international coordination against terror groups, including entities listed under the UN Security Council's 1267 sanctions regime.

The two countries also committed to disrupting terror financing channels, including through cooperation at the United Nations and the Financial Action Task Force.

Modi thanked Norway for backing India after the Pahalgam terror attack last year, in which 26 people, mostly tourists, were killed.

“I was scheduled to visit Norway last year, but the trip had to be postponed due to the terrorist attack in Pahalgam. During that difficult time, Norway stood firmly with India against terrorism,” he said. The leaders also agreed on the need to reform global institutions to better respond to emerging international challenges. Norway reiterated its support for India's bid for permanent membership in a reformed United Nations Security Council. Modi said India and Europe were entering a “new golden era” in relations at a time of global instability.

Separately, the Indian prime minister was conferred with Norway's highest civilian honour for foreign heads of government, the Grand Cross of the Royal Norwegian Order of Merit.

King Harald V presented the award at a special ceremony, recognising Modi's contribution to strengthening India-Norway ties and his leadership.

This was Modi's 32nd international honour.

Accepting the award, Modi thanked the Norwegian monarch and the people of Norway, dedicating the honour to the friendship between the two nations.

“Honoured to receive the Grand Cross of the Royal Norwegian Order of Merit. This honour is dedicated to the people of India and is a tribute to the enduring friendship between India and Norway,” Modi said in a social media post later.

The Ministry of External Affairs said the award reflected the goodwill between the two countries and would guide future collaboration.

Modi's Norway visit, his first to the country and the first by an Indian prime minister in 43 years, was part of his broader multinational European tour focused on expanding partnerships in trade, green technology, strategic connectivity, and innovation. He also met Norwegian business leaders during the visit before proceeding to the next leg of his tour.

Citizenship Rules

(Amendment) Act, 2019, which allows undocumented non-Muslim migrants from Pakistan, Bangladesh and Afghanistan who entered India on or before December 31, 2014, to apply for Indian citizenship.

NEET-UG

questions that appeared in the NEET exam held on 3rd May,” a CBI spokesperson said.

The CBI has described Motegaonkar as an “active member of the organised gang” responsible for leaking and circulating the

paper. Investigators say he distributed copies of the leaked questions to several people in the form of handwritten notes, which were destroyed after the exam was held.

The Rouse Avenue Court in Delhi granted nine days of CBI custody for Motegaonkar, one day short of the ten days the agency had sought for questioning.

The arrested individuals have been picked up from Delhi, Jaipur, Gurugram, Nasik, Pune, Latur and Ahilyanagar, indicating the scale of the network under investigation. Among those already in custody are chemistry lecturer P V Kulkarni and biology lecturer Manisha Mandhare, both connected through a woman named Manisha Waghmare, who is also being held by the CBI.

The two lecturers had allegedly brought in Waghmare to gather NEET aspirants for special coaching sessions held before the exam. Students who attended these sessions reportedly paid several lakh rupees, during which exam questions were dictated and discussed. Those questions later “talked exactly” with the actual NEET-UG paper, officials said.

“Investigation is continuing with the special teams and the investigation conducted so far has brought out the actual source of the leakage of chemistry and biology papers which were circulated before the exam. Further, the middlemen involved in mobilising the students who paid lakhs of rupees to attend the special coaching classes have also been arrested,” the CBI spokesperson said.

In the 24 hours before Motegaonkar's arrest, the agency conducted searches at five locations and recovered laptops, mobile phones and documents. The seized mobile phone of the accused has been sent for forensic analysis to retrieve deleted data, if any.

The NTA said it received information about the alleged malpractice on the evening of May 7, four days after the exam. The inputs were then passed to central agencies for verification. The exam was subsequently cancelled.

Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan has announced that the NEET-UG re-examination will be held on June 21, and that the medical entrance test will shift to a computer-based format from next year. At the parliamentary level, a Standing Committee on Education has summoned NTA Chairperson Pradeep Kumar Joshi and Higher Education Secretary Vineet Joshi to appear before it on May 21. The committee, headed by Congress leader Digvijaya Singh, will review the paper leak investigation and the implementation of the K Radhakrishnan Committee's recommendations on NTA reforms.

Separately, Congress chief whip in the Rajya Sabha Jairam Ramesh filed a privilege notice against Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan, alleging that remarks made by him at a press conference following the leak lowered the dignity of Parliament.

Senior IJML leader P K Kunhalikutty, RSP leader Shibu Baby John, Kerala Congress leader Mons Joseph, Kerala Congress (Jacob) leader Anoop Jacob, and CMP leader C P John were also sworn in as ministers to rousing cheers from the crowd energised by the UDF's large victory.

There are 14 new faces in the Cabinet, including Satheesan, who is holding such a government position for the first time despite being elected from the Paravur Assembly seat near Kochi since 2001.

promised for the injured. In Uttar Pradesh's Lakhimpur Kheri district, 10 people were killed after a van collided head-on with a truck on the Sisaiya-Lakhimpur National Highway, police said.

The accident took place between Unchgaon and Bharehta villages when the van was travelling from Lakhimpur towards Sisaiya. Circle Officer of Dhaurahra Shamsheer Bahadur Singh said all nine passengers in the van and the driver died in the crash.

District Magistrate Anjani Kumar Singh said nine people died at the scene, while one person later died during treatment at the dis-

section for the new Cabinet which held its first meeting at the state secretariat and decided to implement two of the five programmes announced by Rahul Gandhi during the launch of the Assembly election campaign in March.

This includes free travel for women on KSRTC buses from June 15 and the creation of a dedicated department for elderly people, which, according to the CM, is the “first of its kind” in the country.

The other guarantees announced by Gandhi during the elections are a monthly stipend of Rs 1,000 for girl students in colleges, an increase in the welfare pension to Rs 3,000, health insurance coverage of up to Rs 25 lakh per household, and interest-free loans of up to Rs 5 lakh for young entrepreneurs.

Fulfilling a promise made during the prolonged agitation by ASHA workers in front of the Secretariat during the Left rule, the UDF Cabinet also approved an increase of Rs 3,000 per month in their honorarium, taking the total monthly remuneration to Rs 12,000.

Although this falls short of the commitment made in the UDF poll manifesto, Satheesan said the promises would be implemented in a phased manner.

Satheesan said that the government would increase the monthly remuneration of Anganwadi workers and helpers by Rs 1,000.

He added that an additional Rs 1,000 per month would be given to school cooking staff, and that the honorarium of pre-primary teachers and ayahs (nannies) would also be increased by Rs 1,000.

Populist measures were announced after the UDF alleged that the state's finances were in dire straits. In view of this, Satheesan said that a white paper would be issued detailing the state's financial condition and the government exchequer.

He also announced key decisions related to the convening of the new Assembly session on May 21 and 22 for the swearing-in of MLAs and the election of the Speaker. The Governor's policy address will take place on May 29.

In another major decision, the Cabinet approved the constitution of a Special Investigation Team (SIT) to reinvestigate a case related to the alleged assault on two Youth Congress workers by gunmen of the then Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan during a protest against the Nava Kerala Yatra in Alappuzha in 2023. A D Thomas, who won the election from Alappuzha, was among the Youth Congress leaders who suffered injuries.

Satheesan dismissed the suggestion that it was a political vendetta and said the government was only implementing the court's directive. Senior IJML leader P K Kunhalikutty, RSP leader Shibu Baby John, Kerala Congress leader Mons Joseph, Kerala Congress (Jacob) leader Anoop Jacob, and CMP leader C P John were also sworn in as ministers to rousing cheers from the crowd energised by the UDF's large victory.

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Accidents

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District Magistrate Anjani Kumar Singh said nine people died at the scene, while one person later died during treatment at the dis-

trict hospital.

Police identified six of the deceased as residents of Bahraich district: Jaiver Singh, 25, Pawan Kumar, 23, Sohan, 21, Rajesh Goyal, 45, Sahajram, 35, and Pappu, 18. The others were Adnan Khan, 19, from Lakhimpur Kheri, Julekha, 55, Kailash, 40, both from Lakhimpur Kheri district, and Gayatri Vaishya, 44, from Sitapur district.

President Murmu described the loss of lives as “extremely heart-breaking” and offered condolences to the bereaved families while praying for the recovery of the injured.

Prime Minister Modi said he was deeply pained by the accident and announced an ex gratia payment of Rs 2 lakh from the Prime Minister's National Relief Fund for the families of each deceased and Rs 50,000 for the injured.

Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath also expressed grief and said the state government would provide Rs 2 lakh to the family of each victim. He said local authorities had been directed to provide immediate assistance.

In Maharashtra's Palghar district, 13 people were killed and 20 others injured after a tempo carrying guests to an engagement ceremony collided with a container trailer on the Mumbai-Ahmedabad Highway.

The accident occurred near Dhaniwari village in Dahanu taluka at around 4 pm. Officials said the Eicher tempo was carrying between 30 and 40 passengers who were travelling to the engagement ceremony of Balaram Jairam Dandekar from Bapugaon Khadkipada village. According to the district administration, the tempo was travelling on the wrong side of the Mumbai-Gujarat lane when a trailer coming from the opposite direction lost control and its container struck the left side of the vehicle. A motorcycle was also caught in the crash.

Police said the impact caused both the tempo and trailer to overturn, trapping several passengers underneath. Rescue teams, police personnel and local residents worked to pull victims from the wreckage and clear traffic on the highway. The 13 deceased were identified as Suresh Ratna Lakhat, Pandu Ganpat Lakhat, Kalu Govind Lakhat, Sunil Arjun Dandekar, Chhima Govind Kurhade, Namita Vitthal Dandekar, Sarika Santosh Lakhat, Ayush Sitaram Lakhat, Sagar Namdev Shende, Vandana Shivram Valvi, Saloni Shivram Valvi, Ajay Ahadi and Riyanshi Santosh Lakhat.

Officials said 14 injured people were admitted to Vedanta Hospital in Dahanu, while others were taken to Kasa Sub-District Hospital.

Preliminary findings suggest the tempo may have been carrying passengers beyond capacity. Investigators are also examining excessive speed, the narrow road stretch, and the trailer driver's loss of control. Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnis announced compensation of Rs 5 lakh for the next of kin of each deceased. Police have registered a case and started an investigation. In Bihar, seven people, including a two-month-old girl, died after a truck collided head-on with an auto-rickshaw in Khagaria district.

The accident occurred on National Highway-31 in the Mansi area. Deputy Superintendent of Police Mukul Kumar Ranjan said all those killed were travelling in the auto-rickshaw. The dead included the infant, a woman, a boy and four men.

Four injured people were taken to a government hospital. Officials said efforts were underway to identify the victims and inform their families. Bihar Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary expressed grief over the deaths and announced compensation of Rs 4 lakh for the family of each deceased. He also directed officials to ensure proper treatment for the injured.

The three accidents added to India's continuing road safety burden, with families in three states left dealing with sudden loss within hours of each other.

COMMITTEE SCHEDULED TO HOLD BRIEFING ON MAY 20

VB-G RAM G rollout: Parliamentary panel to review its groundwork

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Parliamentary Standing Committee on Rural Development and Panchayati Raj is scheduled to hold a briefing on May 20 with representatives of the Department of Rural Development on the preparatory work undertaken for implementation of the Viksit Bharat Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission-Gramin (VB-G RAM G).

According to information shared on the Parliament website, officials from the Ministry of Rural Development will brief the panel on the subject, "Preparatory work done for implementation of Viksit Bharat Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission-Gramin (VB-G RAM G)."

The meeting comes days after the Centre announced that the VB-G RAM G Act will come into force across the country from July 1,



REPRESENTATIONAL IMAGE

replacing the two-decade-old Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA).

The government described the move as a "historic transition" in India's rural development architecture aligned with the vision of "Viksit Bharat 2047".

Under the new framework, every rural household whose adult members volunteer to undertake unskilled manual work will be entitled

to 125 days of guaranteed wage employment in a financial year, an increase from the existing 100-day guarantee under MGNREGA.

The Ministry of Rural Development has said the transition from MGNREGA to the new framework would be seamless and ongoing works under the existing scheme as of June 30 would continue under the new system.

The Centre has also said that existing e-KYC verified

Highlights

- » 'Preparatory work done for implementation of Viksit Bharat Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission-Gramin (VB-G RAM G)'
- » The government described the move as a 'historic transition' in India's rural development architecture aligned with the vision of 'Viksit Bharat 2047'

MGNREGA job cards will remain valid until new "Gramin Rozgar Guarantee Cards" are issued, and workers without job cards can continue registering at the gram panchayat level.

The government has maintained that workers will not be denied employment due to pending e-KYC and that wages will continue to be transferred directly into bank or post office accounts through Direct Benefit Transfer.

The ministry has also said draft rules covering wage payments, grievance redressal, allocation norms, administrative expenditure, and transitional provisions are being prepared in consultation with states and Union Territories and would be released for public consultation.

The Centre has earmarked Rs 95,692.31 crore for the programme in 2026-27, describing it as the highest-ever budget estimate allocation for a rural employment programme. With states' contributions, the total outlay is expected to exceed Rs 1.51 lakh crore.

The announcement has, however, triggered political reactions, with the Congress criticising the new law as a "headline-grabbing exercise" and alleging it could lead to greater centralisation and weaken the bargaining power of rural labour.

India set to host Quad foreign ministerial meeting next week

Jaishankar is also likely to hold separate bilateral meetings with the Quad foreign ministers

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: India is set to host a meeting of Quad foreign ministers next week that is expected to deliberate on pressing global challenges, including the fallout of the West Asia crisis and the prevailing situation in the Indo-Pacific, authoritative sources said on Monday.

The New Delhi meeting is planned for May 26, and it is scheduled to be attended by US Secretary of State Marco Rubio, Australian Foreign Minister Penny Wong and Japanese Foreign Minister Motegi Toshimitsu, with Indian External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar presiding over it, they said.

Jaishankar is also likely to hold separate bilateral meetings with the Quad foreign ministers.

The Quad, comprising India, the US, Australia and Japan, has emerged as a key grouping largely focusing on

Takeaways

- » The Quad, comprising India, the US, Australia and Japan, has emerged as a key grouping largely focusing on peace, security and stability in Indo-Pacific region

- » India is hosting the meeting in its capacity as the current chair of the coalition
- » The last Quad foreign ministers' meeting had taken place in Washington DC in July last

peace, security and stability in the Indo-Pacific region.

India is hosting the meeting in its capacity as the current chair of the coalition. There is no official word yet on the planned meeting.

Besides deliberating on the pressing global challenges, including the conflicts in Ukraine and West Asia, the foreign ministers are expected to take stock of cooperation in the Indo-Pacific, a region that has been witnessing increasing Chinese assertiveness.

In the last few years, the Quad has rolled out a number

of initiatives addressing some of the most pressing needs and challenges of the Indo-Pacific region, including in areas of maritime security, infrastructure and connectivity.

In the last Quad summit held in Wilmington, United States, in 2024, top leaders of the grouping unveiled major steps to expand maritime security cooperation in the Indo-Pacific.

The upcoming meeting is also likely to set the broad agenda of the Quad summit that is likely to take place in India later this year.

Work in Kerala begins now: Rahul after Cong-led UDF govt sworn-in

"The people of Keralam fought for this government"

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Soon after the formation of the Congress-led UDF government in Kerala, party chief Mallikarjun Kharge expressed hope that the state will now witness "true progress", while Rahul Gandhi said the "work begins now" in the southern state.

In a post on X, Gandhi said, "The people of Keralam fought for this government. Their voice will guide it.

"Warm congratulations to V D Satheesan ji and the entire Cabinet, who will now represent the voice of every Keralite. Thanks to K C Venugopal



ji, who led this campaign from the frontlines.

"This victory belongs to every UDF worker and digital warrior who sacrificed tirelessly during this campaign," Gandhi said in his post.

"The work begins now," he further said. Kharge also extended his

congratulations to V D Satheesan and the Council of Ministers as the new government was sworn in.

"I am confident that under the collective leadership of the Congress-UDF, Keralam will now witness true progress and future-led development. Dignity, justice, freedom, inclusion, and amity remain the pillars of our commitment," Kharge said.

Both Kharge and Gandhi attended the swearing-in ceremony of Satheesan as Kerala Chief Minister along with his Cabinet colleagues. They also shared pictures of the swearing-in.

UP Cabinet gives nod to OBC commission for Panchayat bodies

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: The Uttar Pradesh Cabinet on Monday approved the formation of an Other Backward Classes (OBC) commission for conducting Panchayat elections in the state. The decision was taken in a Cabinet meeting chaired by Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath.

The commission will determine reservation for OBCs in Panchayat elections and only after its report is submitted will the election process move forward. With the panel expected to take up to six months to complete its work, the Panchayat elections are now likely to be held

after the 2027 Uttar Pradesh Assembly elections.

The commission will comprise five members and will be headed by a retired High Court judge. Its tenure has been fixed at six months, which means the report may be submitted by November 2026. Reservation for various seats in Gram Panchayats, block Panchayats and district Panchayats will be decided only after the report is finalised.

The move comes in compliance with a February 4, 2025 order of the Allahabad High Court directing the state government to constitute such a commission before conducting local body polls with OBC

reservation.

The report and survey conducted by the commission will determine which Panchayat seats in different regions will be reserved for OBC candidates, including women and men, and which seats will remain unreserved.

The state government's decision is linked to the "triple test" formula laid down by the Supreme Court for granting OBC reservation in local body elections.

The apex court had ruled that states must complete a dedicated exercise before implementing OBC quotas in local bodies such as Gram Panchayats and Zila Panchayats.

ADR: 18 of 20 Kerala ministers analysed face criminal cases

The analysis is based on the self-sworn affidavits of 20 out of 21 ministers, including CM Satheesan

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A report by the Association for Democratic Reforms and the Kerala Election Watch has found that 18 of the 20 Kerala ministers whose affidavits were analysed have declared criminal cases against their names, while 15 are crorepatists.

The analysis is based on the self-sworn affidavits of 20 out of 21 ministers, including Chief Minister V D Satheesan, who were sworn in on Monday as the Congress-led UDF returned to power in Kerala after a gap of 10 years.

The affidavit of minister C P John from Thiruvananthapuram was not analysed as the document uploaded on the Election Commission website was unclear at the time of preparing the report, the Association for Democratic Reforms (ADR) said.

The report said that 18 min-



Kerala Governor Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar with newly sworn-in state Chief Minister V D Satheesan and the Council of ministers after the swearing-in ceremony of the state govt, in Thiruvananthapuram

isters, or 90 per cent of those analysed, have declared criminal cases against their names. Of these, 14, or 70 per cent, face serious criminal cases.

On the assets front, the report said that 15 of the 20 ministers analysed, or 75 per cent, are crorepatists. The average assets declared by the 20 ministers stood at Rs 6.32 crore.

According to the report, Chavara MLA Shibu Baby

John has declared the highest assets at Rs 24.63 crore, while Kodungallur legislator O J Janeesh declared the lowest at Rs 57.08 lakh.

The report also examined the educational, age and gender profiles of the ministers.

It found that three ministers, or 15 per cent, have educational qualifications between Class 10 and Class 12, while 17, or 85 per cent, have qualifications of graduate level or above.

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: The Directorate of Enforcement (ED) on Monday arrested Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) member and former MLA candidate Deepak Singla in connection with an alleged money laundering and hawala network linked to a bank fraud case involving more than Rs 150 crore.

Investigations point toward illicit flows connected to banking irregularities exceeding Rs 150 crore. Authorities acted following extended scrutiny of transaction trails. Links between offshore movements and domestic accounts raised regulatory flags. Legal procedures now proceed under economic offense protocols. Prior surveillance contributed to timing of the intervention. Financial oversight units coordinated initial phases of evidence gathering.

It is reported that enforcement authorities conducted inspections across several locations in Delhi and Goa connected to Deepak Singla along with individuals believed to be involved in informal money transfer systems. Allegedly,

BANK FRAUD CASE AAP's Deepak Singla arrested after ED raids

He refused to join BJP: Kejriwal on Singla's arrest

NEW DELHI: AAP chief Arvind Kejriwal on Monday came out in defence of party leader Deepak Singla after he was arrested by the ED in an alleged money laundering case, saying he was facing the repercussions of refusing to join the BJP.

Singla was arrested by the Enforcement Directorate (ED) after searches in Delhi and Goa led to the alleged recovery of incriminating documents, according to officials.

"Deepak Singla was not arrested because he did anything wrong. Rather, he was arrested because he was working against the BJP and refused to join the BJP. Deepak is brave and fighting for the country," Kejriwal said in a post on X in Hindi.

these operations moved financial resources between two regions under scrutiny, tied indirectly to political funding activities associated with the AAP. Evidence points toward coordinated efforts outside formal banking channels during the period examined.

Among those named in the findings was Deepak Singla, whose involvement emerged alongside family ties to Ashok Kumar Mittal, a connection through blood also shared with Raman Singla, while links extended further to Harish Sin-

gla - all said to have taken part in securing over Rs 150 crore from Oriental Bank of Commerce under false pretences.

Though official records remain restrained, financial investigators pointed toward coordinated misrepresentations made during loan processing phases.

Officials said that money reportedly taken had moved to companies under control of the accused based in Singapore. Following this, investigators believe some illicit gains returned to India via informal transfer sys-

tems, then entered unlawful operations tied to those involved.

Under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act, enforcement steps were initiated by the ED.

Financial flows are now being reviewed - alongside offshore transfers, fictitious companies, and informal value transfer systems - according to officials familiar with the matter.

Among the findings were financial records, electronics - possibly tied to the alleged laundering network - alongside various items collected by authorities during inspection. Seizures occurred as part of an inquiry said to focus on suspicious fund movements. Evidence gathering followed reports of irregular transactions traced to multiple locations. What emerged was a pattern suggesting coordinated concealment efforts uncovered through document analysis.

Investigation continues into suspected connections linking the reported hawala system to sources of political finance. At present, authorities are examining evidence under ongoing scrutiny.

'Whenever our neighbour done napak harqat, it's been given befitting reply'

NEW DELHI: Defence minister Rajnath Singh on Monday said whenever India's neighbour has done any nefarious act, it has been given a befitting reply as he asserted that any misadventure will draw an effective response.

Singh made the remarks while addressing the Indian diaspora in Hanoi, Vietnam.

"Whenever our neighbour has done any 'napak harqat' (nefarious act) -- and by 'napak,' you must have understood exactly whose actions I am referring to -- every time, it has been given a befitting reply. Now, they should not do it henceforth," he said without naming Pakistan.

Addressing the gathering, the defence minister also recalled Operation Sindoor that India launched in May last year in response to the deadly Pahalgam attack.



Financing Infrastructure for Viksit Bharat



Profit After Tax
₹ 4,034.37 CR
48.82% YOY

Revenue From Operation
₹ 13,150.40 CR
27.54% YOY

Loan Disbursement
₹ 51,194 CR
28% YOY

Loan Sanctions
₹ 1,64,758 CR
29% YOY

PARTICULARS	STANDALONE		CONSOLIDATED	
	31/03/2026 (Audited)	31/03/2025 (Audited)	31/03/2026 (Audited)	31/03/2025 (Audited)
Total Income from Operations (Net)	3,562.86	2,844.99	13,150.40	10,311.29
Net Profit for the Period (before tax & exceptional items)	621.01	1,020.26	3,221.44	3,636.66
Net Profit for the Period before tax (after exceptional items)	621.01	1,020.26	3,221.44	3,636.66
Net Profit for the Period after tax (after exceptional items)	1,981.31	727.74	4,034.37	2,709.14
Total Comprehensive Income for the period (comprising Profit for the period (after tax) and other comprehensive income (after tax))	2,007.31	627.38	3,477.15	2,544.34
Paid up Equity Share Capital (FV - ₹ 10/- each)	2,001.90	2,001.90	2,001.90	2,001.90
Other Equity (excluding Revaluation Reserve)	N.A.	N.A.	18,533.30	15,967.89
Securities Premium Account	N.A.	N.A.	1.26	1.26
Net Worth*	N.A.	N.A.	21,977.20	21,975.46
Paid up Debt Capital/ Outstanding Debt*	-	-	1,41,389.61	107,280.61
Debt Equity Ratio	N.A.	N.A.	6.43	5.72
Earning per Share (FV - ₹ 10/- each) (The EPS for quarters are not annualised)				
i) Basic	9.90	3.64	20.15	13.53
ii) Diluted	9.90	3.64	20.15	13.53
Debt Redemption Reserve**(as at year end)	N.A.	N.A.	3,095.50	2,965.69

* Outstanding Debt excluding Ind AS Adjustments ** Debt Redemption Reserve as on 31st March 2026 and 31st March 2025 respectively. A Including Perpetual Debt (URL: www.nseindia.com/corporates) and the same is also available on the company's website (URL: www.hudco.org.in).

1. The above financial results of the company have been reviewed by the Audit Committee and subsequently approved by the Board of Directors in their meeting held on 14/05/2026. These financial results have also been audited by M/s SHRC & Associates, Chartered Accountants, Statutory Auditors of the Company.

2. The Board of the Company recommended a Final Dividend @ ₹1.50 per share of ₹10 each subject to approval in the AGM.

3. The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly/ Yearly Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 and 52(4) of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirement) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the financial results is available on the website of BSE Limited (URL: www.bseindia.com/corporates), National Stock Exchange of India Limited (URL: www.nseindia.com/corporates) and the same is also available on the company's website (URL: www.hudco.org.in).

4. The other line items referred in regulation 52(4) of the Listing Regulation, pertinent disclosures have been made to the website of BSE Limited (URL: www.bseindia.com/corporates), National Stock Exchange of India Limited (URL: www.nseindia.com/corporates) and the same is also available on the company's website (URL: www.hudco.org.in).

5. There has been update in the accounting policy during the quarter/ year ended period. However, there is no material financial impact on net profit/loss, total comprehensive income or any other relevant financial item(s) due to update in accounting policies.

For and on behalf of the Board of Directors

Sd/-
Sanjay Kulshrestha
Chairman & Managing Director

OTHER SERVICES

Consultancy Capacity Building

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AMIT SHAH IN BASTAR

‘Dream to end Naxalism realised with sacrifices’

MPOST BUREAU

JAGDALPUR (CHHATTISGARH): Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Monday said that India is now “by and large” free from the three major internal security challenges of Naxalism, terrorism in Jammu and Kashmir and insurgency in the Northeast. Addressing a programme in Jagdalpur, located in the Bastar region once considered a Maoist stronghold, Shah said both the Centre and the Chhattisgarh government were committed to ensuring permanent peace and development in the area.

Shah, who is on a three-day visit to Chhattisgarh, his first after the country was declared free from Maoist violence in March, appealed to the people of Bastar to accept around 3,000 surrendered Naxals and help them return to the



Union Home minister Amit Shah pays tribute at the statue of tribal freedom fighter Gunda Dhur during a visit to Netanar village, in Bastar. Chhattisgarh CM Vishnu Deo Sai and others are also seen

national mainstream. He is scheduled to chair the 26th Central Zonal Council meeting in Jagdalpur on Tuesday, which will be attended by the chief ministers of Chhattisgarh, Madhya Pradesh, Uttar Pradesh and Uttarakhand.

Speaking at an event organ-

ised at the Bastar Academy of Dance, Art and Literature (BADAL), Shah described the occasion as historic and credited the sacrifices of security personnel for ending decades of Maoist violence. He said Left Wing Extremism, which emerged in the 1970s, had

HIGHLIGHTS

» Shah said India is now ‘by and large’ free from the 3 major internal security challenges of Naxalism, terrorism in J&K and insurgency in the Northeast

» Shah appealed to the people of Bastar to accept around 3,000 surrendered Naxals

PTI

consumed three generations through violence and deprived people of basic facilities and opportunities. Shah recalled that when the Narendra Modi government came to power in 2014, the country was dealing with serious challenges related to Jammu and Kashmir, the

Northeastern states and Maoist violence. “I can now say that, by and large, the country is free from these three problems,” he said.

During the event, Shah interacted with families of civilians killed in Maoist violence, security personnel who had shown bravery during anti-Naxal operations and tribal leaders from the Bastar region. He also paid tribute at Amar Vatika to more than 1,000 security personnel who lost their lives in the fight against Maoists. “The sacrifices of our jawans in establishing peace, security and development in Bastar region will never be forgotten,” Shah said. He added that both the Centre and the state government were working with full commitment to ensure lasting peace and development in the region.

The Union minister also

honoured police personnel from different states, Central Armed Police Forces (CAPFs) and the NIA for their role in anti-Maoist operations. Appealing to community leaders in Bastar’s seven districts, Shah urged them to forget past bitterness and support the rehabilitation of surrendered Naxals.

He assured that Bastar would emerge as the most developed tribal region in the country within the next five years. Shah also announced that around 70 of the nearly 200 CAPF camps in Chhattisgarh would be redeveloped into public service centres to provide welfare services and development facilities to local residents. Shah praised the CRPE, its CoBRA unit and the Chhattisgarh Police for their role in anti-Maoist operations.

WITH PTI INPUTS

Punjab CM claims Centre pushed country into undeclared lockdown

CHANDIGARH: Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann on Monday attacked the BJP-led Centre, accusing it of pushing the country into an undeclared lockdown while hiding the true state of the economy from people.

Alleging that the Centre “artificially suppressed” fuel prices until recent Assembly elections in several states and is now “burdening” citizens immediately afterwards, Mann demanded that the Union government disclose the actual status of the country’s oil, gas, and gold reserves. Mann was speaking to reporters in Patna after offering prayers at the Takht Sri Harmandir ji Patna Sahib.

The CM said the Narendra Modi-led government has “effectively imposed an unde-

clared lockdown” on the country. “The consequences of these restrictions are being borne by the entire nation while the Centre continues to hide the real condition of the economy from people,” he claimed.

“The people of the country have the right to know the truth about the economic situation. The Centre should place complete information regarding oil, gas, and gold reserves before the public instead of concealing facts,” he said.

Targeting the Centre over fuel price hikes, Mann said the central government deliberately refrained from increasing prices before assembly elections in various states but immediately after the elections concluded, fuel prices were increased by Rs 3 per litre.

He said, “Under the guise of war in West Asia, people are being crushed under the burden of inflation through repeated fuel price hikes.”

Taking a swipe at the PM, Mann said if Narendra Modi cannot himself explain the country’s present economic condition and foreign policy, then he should ask “his friend, US President Donald Trump, about it.” About “restrictions” being imposed on citizens, Mann said it was ironic that Modi was advising people to avoid foreign travel while he himself was travelling abroad.

He said the country was passing through strange circumstances where ‘work from home’ was being promoted but the real truth was being hidden from people.

MPOST

FAKE DEGREES, CELEBRITY LINKS

UP: Kanpur police bust pan-India education fraud racket, 2 arrested

KANPUR: In a major crackdown, Kanpur police have busted an alleged inter-state fake degree racket involved in supplying forged mark-sheets, migration certificates and professional degrees without candidates appearing for examinations, officials said on Monday.

The operation was carried out jointly by the Kidwai Nagar Police and a Special Investigation Team (SIT), leading to the arrest of two alleged masterminds — Manish alias Ravi (40), a resident of Hyderabad, and Arjun Yadav of Unnao. Police described the network as a highly organised “home delivery” system for fake educational documents.

Police Commissioner Raghbir Lal said the gang had allegedly been operating for several years and provided forged certificates ranging from high school and graduation documents to postgraduate, LLB, B.Pharm and even PhD degrees. During raids conducted as part of the investigation, police recovered around 80 fake migration certificates, forged mark-sheets and degrees, counterfeit university seals, two laptops and two mobile phones containing digital records allegedly linked to thousands of beneficiaries.

According to investigators, the forged documents carried the names of several universities and institutions, including

Lingaya’s Vidyapeeth, Mangalayatan University, JS University, Glocal University, Sikkim Professional University and Chhatrapati Shahu Ji Maharaj University.

Police said the accused had also allegedly prepared fake migration booklets and forged the seal of a deputy registrar of CSJM University to issue bogus migration certificates.

Financial transactions connected to the racket are also under investigation.

Investigators also recovered photographs of Manish with several Bollywood personalities and sportspersons. Police are probing whether such associations were used to gain credibility and attract clients.

AGENCIES

DESPITE STRONG RECOVERY IN PASSENGER TRAFFIC

Aviation Security Fee dues hover around Rs 3,200 cr

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: India’s civil aviation sector continues to face a major financial challenge, with pending Aviation Security Fee (ASF) dues still estimated at nearly Rs 3,200 crore despite the strong recovery in passenger traffic after the COVID-19 pandemic.

Though movement through airports has rebounded sharply, settlement of these fees lags behind expected timelines. Recovery in travel demand does little to erase accumulated obligations tied to safety funding mechanisms. Authorities continue monitoring cash flow gaps linked to delayed payments under current regulatory frameworks.

Despite growing expenses and pandemic-related interruptions, the fees gathered from travellers for airport safety managed by the Cen-

tral Industrial Security Force remain strained. At present, protection at 72 civilian airfields throughout the nation is maintained by the CISF. While financial demands climb, support continues without pause.

On July 1, 2019, the Ministry of Civil Aviation (MoCA) launched the National Aviation Security Fee Trust (NASFT). Managed as a single nonprofit entity, it gathers airport security fees under one system. Instead of scattered oversight, funds now flow into a unified structure. Created for clarity, its purpose centres on organised financial control.

With consolidation came improved tracking – each contribution accounted for separately. Though formed by government directive, operations follow strict neutrality. Pooling resources allows consistency where variation once existed.

Beginning in 2017, structural adjustments to the ASF occurred multiple times, driven by growing expenses tied to security operations. While held unchanged at Rs 130 for close to twenty years through the prior fee framework, the local ASF amount moved upward – first reaching Rs 150 during mid-2019. Later, a further shift brought it to Rs 160 near the end of 2020; then, starting April 2021, it settled at Rs 200. On overseas routes, fees climbed too: beginning below four dollars, they now stand at twelve per passenger.

Even after adjustments, revenue dropped sharply due to the pandemic since fewer passengers meant lower receipts, but CISF expenses stayed constant. At its highest point, unpaid amounts reached about Rs 4,707 crore by November 2022. By March 2026, what remained outstanding had

declined to roughly Rs 3,200 crore. Of that sum, close to Rs 2,100 crore came from privately managed and jointly operated terminals. Publicly administered facilities accounted for nearly Rs 1,100 crore within the total balance. Unexpectedly, during 2024, airport operators took on financial responsibility for securing approximately 1,200 CISF staff stationed at freight hubs – part of a broader move to reduce strain on the ASF fund. While not formally announced, the change quietly reshaped cost distribution across aviation infrastructure. Because operational demands shifted, funding flows followed. Thus, a new burden fell upon terminal authorities without altering overall security mandates.

Following this adjustment, budgetary relief emerged elsewhere, though details remain sparse.

BACK TO PREPARATION ROUTINES

Vacations cut short as NEET-UG re-exam brings aspirants back to Kota

KOTA: Just days after leaving Kota with the relief of having finished one of India’s toughest medical entrance exams, Anamika Verma found herself unpacking her belongings again in the same hostel room she had hoped never to return to. “I went back to Lucknow after the NEET exam, but returned to Kota because studies don’t happen at home... the environment is missing,” she said on Monday, as she settled into her room, arranging her books and a study table.

Like Anamika, several medical aspirants are slowly making their way back to Kota, the country’s coaching capital, after the National Testing Agency (NTA) announced a re-examination for NEET-UG on June 21 following the cancellation of the May 3 paper.

The return of aspirants to Kota has revived the city’s unique student ecosystem -- discipline, structured hostel environment, shared anxiety and relentless preparation.

“The momentum is alive in Kota. The test series has also started, so I came back. Many



REPRESENTATIVE PIC

friends in my circle are returning too,” Anamika said.

For many students, the cancellation of the exam did not just disrupt academic plans; it abruptly interrupted a rare moment of relief after years of preparation. And now, they are once again slipping back into routines they had mentally exited weeks ago. “After giving the NEET paper, we had chilled out and even made travel plans,” said Anshika Gureya from Madhya Pradesh. “But as soon as we learned the paper was cancelled, the mood turned off.” Her family had planned a vacation after the exam, something postponed repeatedly

during the months of preparation. The trip was cancelled.

“Since Kota is nearby, I have returned to prepare here. I will study from the hostel because that level of focus is not possible at home,” she said.

This sentiment is emerging as the biggest reason behind the partial migration back to Kota.

Students say it is not necessarily the coaching classes pulling them back, but the psychological structure of the city itself -- the competitive atmosphere, fixed schedules, late-night discussions, silent libraries and the constant reminder that everyone around them is preparing for the same

KEY POINTS

» For many students, the cancellation of the exam did not just disrupt academic plans; it abruptly interrupted a rare moment of relief after years of preparation

» Now, they are once again slipping back into routines they had mentally exited weeks ago

goal. Students from Rajasthan, Uttar Pradesh, Madhya Pradesh and Gujarat are among those returning to Kota in noticeable numbers, while aspirants from farther states are continuing preparation from home through online platforms.

For Diksha Pandey from Ranchi, returning for barely a month did not seem practical.

“The target was to appear for the exam, so the routine was set accordingly. We had mentally relaxed after the exam. Then came the news of cancellation,” she said. “Going back to Kota for just a month is not practical. So, I am preparing from Jharkhand online.”

PTI

UP: 17,043 police encounter in past 9 years

LUCKNOW: The Yogi Adityanath government’s sustained crackdown against crime and criminals in Uttar Pradesh over the last nine years has led to the neutralisation of 289 dreaded criminals in police encounters.

During this period, the police conducted a total of 17,043 encounter operations, arresting 34,253 criminals. 11,834 criminals were injured in these encounters.

At the same time, 18 police personnel were martyred in the line of duty and 1,852 were injured, the state government said in a statement issued Monday. The highest number of encounters were recorded in the Meerut Zone, where police carried out 4,813 operations. In these actions, 8,921 criminals were arrested, with 3,513 injured. As many as 97 notorious criminals were killed on the spot.

During these operations, 477 police personnel were injured while two were martyred on duty in the Meerut Zone, ranked first in the state in terms of encounters.

MPOST

Ebola surveillance measures rolled out

‘Risk to India remains minimal’

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Surveillance and preparedness measures are being strengthened at points of entry and across the public health system as a matter of caution amid the recent Ebola outbreak in parts of the Democratic Republic of Congo (DRC) and Uganda, official sources said on Monday.

They said the Union Health Ministry is closely monitoring developments after the World Health Organization (WHO) declared the outbreak a Public Health Emergency of International Concern (PHEIC).

Senior officials of the Union Health Ministry, including representatives from the National Centre for Disease Control (NCDC), Integrated Disease Surveillance Programme (IDSP), ICMR and other concerned divisions, have reviewed the evolving situation and initiated precautionary public health measures, sources said.

A senior health ministry official clarified that no case of Ebola, caused by the Bundibugyo virus strain, has been reported in India, and the current risk to the country remains minimal. However, as a matter of abundant caution, surveillance and preparedness measures are being strengthened at points of entry and within the public health system to ensure early detection and rapid response in the event of any suspected case, the official said.

Key preparedness measures include reviewing standard operating procedures (SOPs) related to screening, surveillance, quarantine and case management, while laboratory preparedness is also being strengthened, sources said.

The National Institute of Virology (NIV), Pune, has been designated for testing,

INSIGHT

» Citizens have been advised to follow official updates issued by the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare and the WHO

» This comes amid the recent Ebola outbreak in parts of the Democratic Republic of Congo (DRC) and Uganda

» A senior health ministry official clarified that no case of Ebola, caused by the Bundibugyo virus strain, has been reported in India

» However, as a matter of abundant caution, surveillance and preparedness measures are being strengthened

and additional laboratories are being onboarded in phases, they said. Coordination with relevant ministries and agencies for monitoring international travel from affected regions is also being enhanced.

Authorities are additionally focusing on the identification and operational readiness of isolation and quarantine facilities at major airports and ports.

The ministry has urged the public and media not to panic or circulate unverified information, asserting that India’s public health system remains vigilant and fully prepared to respond to any emerging situation. Citizens have been advised to follow official updates issued by the Health ministry and the WHO. The government continues to maintain close coordination with international health authorities and will take all necessary measures to safeguard public health.

Nation Briefs

NFR INSTALLS MODERN AUTOMATIC BLOCK SIGNALLING

MALIGAON: The Katihar Division of Northeast Frontier Railway (NFR) has successfully commissioned Automatic Block Signalling (ABS) in the Panjipara–Kishanganj–Hatwar–Kanki–Surjakamal section. The newly commissioned ABS section spans approximately 30 kilometres and covers five stations, comprising three Electronic Interlocking (EI) stations and two Panel Interlocking (PI) stations. As part of the commissioning work, four Auto Signal huts have been provided to enhance signalling efficiency and operational safety. A total of 14 level crossing gates fall within the section, out of which six gates have been newly interlocked with the automatic signalling system.

MEMU TRAIN SERVICES EXTENDED TO NARKATIAGANJ, SIKTA: ECR

HAJIPUR: The extension of two MEMU passenger train services was inaugurated on Monday at Narkatiaganj railway station. Union Minister of State for Coal and Mines Satish Chandra Dubey and Valmiki-nagar MP Sunil Kumar flagged off the inaugural special train during a ceremony held at the station. Sikta MLA Samridh Verma was also present on the occasion. Under the new arrangement, train number 63373/74 Darbhanga–Raxaul MEMU passenger train has been extended up to Narkatiaganj station, while train number 63313/14 Muzaffarpur–Raxaul MEMU passenger train has been extended up to Sikta station, the East Central Railway said on Tuesday.



EDITORIAL

BALANCING ACT?

The Middle East's shifting alliances have often been built as much on discretion as on diplomacy. Yet, in the past week, that carefully maintained ambiguity surrounding the relationship between Israel and the United Arab Emirates was abruptly pushed into the spotlight. The revelation by US Ambassador to Israel Mike Huckabee that Israel had reportedly deployed Iron Dome systems and personnel to assist the UAE against Iranian threats, followed by Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's public disclosure of a wartime visit to Abu Dhabi, has exposed not merely strategic cooperation but also the deep discomfort that still surrounds Arab-Israeli normalisation in the wider region. The UAE's swift and carefully worded denial of Netanyahu's visit is perhaps more revealing than the original disclosure itself. Abu Dhabi did not deny that diplomatic relations with Israel exist. Those ties were formally established under the Abraham Accords in 2020 and have since expanded across trade, technology, tourism and security. Instead, the UAE objected to the public framing of the relationship during a highly volatile regional conflict. The denial reflected the Gulf monarchy's continuing preference for strategic quietude over overt political theatre.

This episode underlines a central contradiction in the Abraham Accords experiment. While governments in parts of the Arab world may see cooperation with Israel as strategically useful, large sections of public opinion continue to view Israel with deep hostility, particularly after the devastating war in Gaza. The destruction in Gaza, the enormous Palestinian death toll and the continuing regional military spill-over into Lebanon, Yemen and elsewhere have reinforced anger across Arab societies. In such an atmosphere, any Arab government perceived as openly aligning itself with Israel during wartime risks domestic backlash and regional reputational costs. The UAE, therefore, finds itself balancing two competing realities. On one side lies hard strategic calculation. Iran remains a source of security concern for Gulf monarchies despite periodic diplomatic outreach. Access to Israeli military technology, intelligence capabilities and defence systems offers the UAE tangible strategic benefits. Economic cooperation, too, has grown rapidly since normalisation, creating mutual commercial incentives. Israel gains something equally valuable: legitimacy and regional acceptance after decades of diplomatic isolation in the Arab world.

Netanyahu's decision to publicise his wartime diplomacy appears driven largely by domestic political calculations. Facing intense political opposition and entering another difficult electoral phase, the Israeli leader seeks to reinforce his image as a statesman capable of reshaping the Middle East. Regional acceptance by Arab powers has long been central to his political narrative. By projecting close ties with Gulf states even during wartime, Netanyahu hopes to show Israeli voters that Israel is no longer isolated despite continuing conflict.

However, the reaction from the UAE suggests that such public signalling may have limits. Gulf countries do not necessarily wish to be drawn visibly into Israel's confrontation with Iran. Their security interests may overlap with Israel's concerns regarding Tehran, but they also recognise the dangers of becoming entangled in a wider regional war whose trajectory they cannot fully control. This distinction is particularly evident in Saudi Arabia's approach during the Iran conflict. Riyadh has maintained communication channels with Tehran while simultaneously engaging other regional and international actors. That balancing posture reflects strategic caution rather than ideological alignment.

Indeed, the broader lesson emerging from the current tensions is that the Middle East is gradually moving towards a more autonomous regional security framework. Gulf powers increasingly seek to shape their own diplomatic and strategic arrangements instead of merely following Washington's priorities. While the United States remains influential, regional actors are displaying greater flexibility and pragmatism in managing rivalries. Countries such as Saudi Arabia and the UAE now pursue multi-directional diplomacy — engaging the United States, maintaining limited communication with Iran, deepening economic partnerships with Asia and selectively cooperating with Israel. The UAE's discomfort over Netanyahu's disclosures also demonstrates that symbolic politics still matter deeply in the Middle East. Arab governments may calculate strategically, but they cannot entirely ignore the emotional and political resonance of the Palestinian issue among their populations. The Gaza war has made this sensitivity even sharper. Any perception that Arab states are helping Israel militarily while Palestinians continue to suffer can quickly become politically toxic.

The current controversy exposes the fragile architecture underpinning the new Middle East order. Strategic cooperation between Israel and parts of the Arab world is real and likely to continue. Yet it remains constrained by public sentiment, regional instability and unresolved political grievances. Quiet diplomacy may continue behind closed doors, but the moment such alliances are thrust too openly into public view, the contradictions become impossible to conceal.

TALKING SHOP



RAJEEV NARAYAN

THE WRITER IS A VETERAN JOURNALIST AND COMMUNICATIONS SPECIALIST

Once-tall malls are no longer just failed retail spaces. They are ugly mirrors reflecting flawed planning, battered aspirations and the loneliness of modern metro life. They also reflect business calculations gone horribly wrong

ALARMING TRENDS



SHANTANU MUKHARJI

THE WRITER IS A RETIRED IPS OFFICER, ADVISER NATSTRAT, AND A FORMER NATIONAL SECURITY ADVISOR IN MAURITIUS

Weak enforcement, political patronage and rising youth vulnerability could deepen lawlessness unless intelligence-led policing and institutional reforms are urgently strengthened

Empty Atriums

India's malls were seen as monuments to aspiration and abundance. Now, they stand empty, air-conditioning clattering, ambition fading and silence resounding

"The problem with shopping malls is that they were built for an era that no longer exists." — Ellen Dunham-Jones

The silent escalators tell the painful story. Especially on weekday evenings in India's metros, when their clitter-clatter is omnispresent in their cacophony inside malls that were once happy places. The escalators groan upward only when ordered to. Straggling students occupy the food court, soft-nursing a paper glass under fluorescent lights and cold, recycled air. Couples wander the deserted corridors, stopping before closed storefronts carrying faded 'Coming Soon' signage. On upper floors, long stretches lie dark and destitute, with a few outlets struggling to survive the ruins of a failed promise. The mall is not dead. But it not alive either.

Across Delhi-NCR, Mumbai, Bengaluru, Hyderabad and other metros, such scenes are familiar. The grand mall experiment — projected as inimitable proof of urban opulence — is dying a slow death. Behind the bright facades, malls battle weak footfalls, rising vacancies, collapsing relevance and failing consumer engagement. Some have even created a new handle — 'Ghost Malls'.

Knight Frank has identified 74 'Ghost Malls' across India's top cities, with vacancies exceeding 40 per cent. One-fifth of still-open malls fall in this category, with 15 million square feet of retail space lying dormant, translating to hundreds of crores in unrealised rental income and dead funding. This alone should force tough questions. How did India, a country celebrated for its consumption boom and expanding middle-class, end up with malls that no one visits? The answer lies not in one failure, but in layered miscalculations — economic, architectural, cultural and psychological. The Great Dream

In the early 2000s, malls symbolised a new India. Glass facades, multiplexes, branded stores, AC interiors and sprawling food courts spawned an entry into a global culture visible only abroad. For India's expanding urban middle class, malls were not shopping destinations, but aspirational spaces. Families spent Sundays there. Teenagers found freedom there. Professionals treated malls as proof that India had arrived. Developers rushed in. Delhi-NCR alone witnessed a mall construction boom. Every emerging sub-



India's malls, once symbols of aspiration and modernity, now stand half-empty, serving more as air-conditioned refuges from chaotic cities than thriving shopping destinations

urb wanted its own. Real estate brochures promised 'global retail experiences', 'Dubai-style destinations' and 'world-class lifestyle hubs'.

For years, developers believed India's consumption boom would endlessly absorb new retail space. Between 2005 and 2015, malls emerged across NCR at warp speed, often less as carefully curated retail ecosystems and more as real-estate products sold floor-by-floor to investors. The flaw in that model became visible soon enough. Fragmented ownership weakened management control, tenant quality deteriorated and malls gradually lost the ability to reinvent themselves coherently when consumer behaviour changed.

Along the way, the mall stopped being a planned urban experience, turning into a real-estate gamble. Too many developers confused construction with creation. The result was oversupply with no imagination. Malls were built with poor connectivity, weak access, fragmented layouts and little understanding of consumer interest. Upper floors became inaccessible dead zones.

Tenant mixes were repetitive. Entertainment offerings became generic. Parking was chaotic. Public transport integration was poor. Malls were treated as pure property investments, not living social ecosystems. The novelty soon faded. And consumers quietly drifted away.

Digital Drift The rise of e-commerce accelerated the decline. Why battle traffic, parking fees and crowded malls for shoes that arrive at one's doorstep at a discount? Amazon, Flipkart and other quick-commerce apps altered shopping behaviour. Convenience replaced outing. Algorithms replaced browsing. Discounts replaced ambience. If at all, malls survived only if they offered something the Internet could not. Ironically, the decline has been unfolding even as organised retail leasing remains strong. The divergence reveals a stark reality: consumers have not abandoned physical retail. They have abandoned forgettable retail.

This explains why only a few malls thrive while others decay. Successful ones like Select Citywalk, DLF Mall and those developed by Phoenix Mills understand

a crucial truth: malls are not retail spaces; they are experience spaces. People visit malls not to shop, but to spend time. To eat, watch films, attend events, meet friends, work remotely or simply escape urban chaos for a few hours.

The difference is profound. The best-performing malls have evolved into hybrid urban environments. The failing ones are stuck in an outdated formula of endless corridors and interchangeable brands. According to Cushman & Wakefield, Grade A+ malls operate with tight vacancy levels, while weaker malls continue suffering vacancies and falling relevance. In plain English, India does not have a 'Mall' problem; it has a 'Bad Mall' problem.

Food Court Nation

The decline is visible inside the food court, the only bustling place. Food court operators say weekday sales have fallen compared to pre-pandemic levels, with profitability hit by rising rentals, costs and LPG prices. In smaller malls, electricity and maintenance charges rival store revenues. Consumers still arrive, but they order less, share meals or linger without purchasing anything. The irony is difficult to miss — India built malls as monuments to consumption when digital commerce began dismantling physical retail economics. Yet, unlike in the US — where dead malls became symbols of suburban decline — India's mall crisis carries a distinctly urban dimension.

Indian cities suffer from an acute shortage of safe, climate-controlled, publicly accessible social spaces. Parks are limited. Footpaths are broken. Public seating is scarce. Summer temperatures are brutal. In such conditions, malls became surrogate public squares. This explains why students, elderly visitors, remote workers and young couples continue to occupy malls even when purchasing power remains weak. They are often consuming space rather than products. The mall, in many cities, has evolved into an air-conditioned refuge from urban exhaustion.

Design Collapse

The uncomfortable truth most ignore is that Indian malls are built badly. Urban planners say India copied the aesthetics of global malls without understanding the urban logic that made them work. Unlike successful retail districts — where shopping merges with walkability, public transport and urban life — Indian malls operate like islands, with deep structural flaws:

isolated locations, dependence on personal conveyance, poor integration with neighbourhoods, weak street connectivity and an absence of engagement. Over time, the consequences become visible. Once anchor tenants leave, smaller stores collapse. Upper floors empty out first. Maintenance declines. Consumer perception weakens. Vacancy breeds more vacancy. The spiral becomes self-sustaining.

In India's top cities, the number of malls is shrinking. Those that once defined urban aspiration now seem relics from another economic era. The atriums remain brightly lit but are emotionally vacant. Newer destinations attract crowds because they have adapted to changing behaviours. The contrast is stark enough to resemble two different industries.

After Today's Malls

Yet, declaring malls dead would be premature. Retail leasing across top cities continues to remain strong, say JLL India and Cushman & Wakefield. But that growth is concentrated in a few premium, experience-led malls. This segregation teaches a lesson that malls cannot survive as shopping centres; they must become more — an urban cultural node, entertainment hub, social commons or lifestyle ecosystem, or all rolled into one. Retail alone no longer guarantees relevance. The surviving malls have understood something fundamental: consumers no longer seek inventory, only meaning. Successful malls behave less like a marketplace and more like a city within a city. Unsuccessful ones still believe row upon row of shops are enough. They are not, and the age of the isolated glass box is ending.

For policymakers and planners, the lesson is important. India's cities need inclusive, accessible and thoughtfully-designed public spaces. If malls become substitutes for parks, boulevards and community infrastructure, something deep has already gone wrong in their design. The empty corridors of today's malls are not a retail story, but a mirror reflecting truths about consumption, planning, aspiration and loneliness. For years, malls promised prosperity wrapped in glass, chrome and air-conditioning. Some succeeded. Many failed. But the great irony is that in trying to become global, too many malls forgot to become human.

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Dhaka's Dangerous Undercurrent

Bangladesh's new regime faces mounting pressure as organised crime, extortion networks and political patronage raise fresh questions over law and order

One had thought that the new Bangladesh regime under Prime Minister Tarique Rahman, which has completed nearly two and a half months in office now, would prioritise the law and order front in addition to other core areas demanding immediate attention. However, despite the best of efforts, that does not seem to be happening, as noticed in a section of the Bangladesh press which has, of late, highlighted the law and order concerns rather prominently. In this context, before dwelling on these specific problem areas confronting the new regime, it must be reiterated that under the interim government, Dhaka and various other parts of Bangladesh had, for nearly one and a half years, seen a complete state of lawlessness and anarchy. Major untoward happenings which followed at electric speed soon after Sheikh Hasina's fall from power included targeted murders, loot and dacoity, including plunder of armouries and other organised crimes. Naturally, with the advent of the new regime under Tarique Rahman, hopes were, and are, raised that there would be some semblance of normalcy.

Coming back to the media assessment, the most widely read *Daily Star*, in its editorial (May 3), carried a damning report stating that the recent spate of violence by criminal groups across Dhaka points to an alarming resurgence of organised crime in the capital that is reminiscent of underworld activities. Simultaneously, a recent report by *Prothom Alo* reveals that the weak law-and-order situation following the political changeover on August 5, 2024, opened the door for organised criminals to make a comeback. Many high-profile criminals secured bail at the time. Now, many of them have unleashed a wave of violence across the city to mark out and control territories as a kind of fiefdom. There was a free-for-all when the crimi-



The resurgence of criminal syndicates is the biggest test for Tarique Rahman

nals had a field day.

According to the media, over the past several months, there have been reports of at least 23 incidents involving professional criminals. Among these incidents, several killings were carried out in public. In the latest incident, Khandokar Noyeem Ahmed Titon, a top criminal who had been out on bail since August 13, two years ago, following a long stay in prison, was assassinated by his rivals in the heart of the capital, Dhaka, on April 28. In many of these cases, the victims were targeted by their adversaries in a bid to remove competition in "business" and are suspected of enjoying some political patronage as well. Besides public executions, the criminal gangs are attacking establishments, issuing intimidating threats and making extortion demands — often via overseas phone numbers.

Further, the report observes a pattern in these attacks that displays a disturbing level of coordination and defiance of the law. Many of these incidents have been planned by fugitive kingpins abroad, communicated digitally, and executed by local gangs. Police assert that several local operatives are recruited from a pool of unem-

ployed, vulnerable youth who are desperate for a source of income. These gang wars are rooted in a crime-driven economy where illegal income streams dictate power dynamics. Criminal syndicates are using violence to assert dominance, while ordinary businesspeople are silently enduring extortion demands, fearing retaliation and lacking confidence in legal protection. Does this mean that public confidence in the law and order agencies is on the wane?

Meanwhile, the police, on their part, claimed that they were preparing an area-wise list of criminals and their affiliates, and would soon launch a "combing operation" against the perpetrators. However, past experiences show that such operations have often failed to stamp out this menace. Another failure on the police's part was perhaps feeble monitoring of criminals who were, and are, out on bail. The lack of proper follow-up, combined with a gap in law enforcement since August 2024, provided these criminals with fertile ground to realign their linkages. Under these circumstances, dismantling these organised crime networks naturally requires a pragmatic approach. Importantly, law enforce-

ment agencies need to prioritise robust intelligence coordination to identify the criminals and their locations, cut off their reach from beyond the border, shut down the flow of funds that facilitate such criminal activities, and ensure airtight monitoring of bail-released criminals. Beyond that, the links binding these criminals and their political patronage need to be nullified. In addition, awareness campaigns and employment opportunities must be planned without further delay to prevent jobless youth from turning to criminal gangs to make a living. This is possibly because it seems to be a social problem.

Judging by the revelations by the police that they are on the job and are likely to address the challenges by drawing up multiple result-oriented measures, it would appear that the government is serious about addressing the problem. Whatever the case, it must be attended to with strict and fool-proof oversight. Once the underworld is allowed to breathe freely and is licensed to enjoy political patronage, it would undo all the steps the government has undertaken so far to refurbish its image towards instilling a sense of security.

Such a mafia-politician nexus and culture of warlords have been rampant in many metropolitan cities the world over, so Dhaka is no exception. Yet, a dedicated intelligence machinery and a perfectly coordinated law and order apparatus can deal with the menace rather effectively. The media blowing the whistle is very timely, and it is assumed that the security and intelligence professionals will heed this early warning. It is not an impossible task. Delivering on the people's expectations will add to the government's credibility and sincerity, and it will also give the government and the party clear political mileage, which they can capitalise upon for visible good governance.

Views expressed are personal

THE PEOPLE OF BANGLADESH STILL BENEFITING FROM THE DEVELOPMENT CARRIED OUT BY THE AWAMI LEAGUE GOVT

I will return with my head held high: Hasina

Says ban on Awami League is temporary, party undergoing natural purification

GAUTAM LAHIRI

country.

Former Bangladesh Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina has not ruled out her return to Dhaka, saying even in 1981 when she returned to her country on May 17 after six years of exile, there were conspiracies against her, threats to her life but she got on to complete the work of development of the country.

In this recorded telephonic conversation, she answers a wide range of questions on economic situation, relations with India, agenda of her Awami League party which is now banned by the government, threat of militancy and her mission of restoring democracy in Bangladesh.

Here are edited excerpts of her interview:

May 17 marks your Homecoming Day. Even if a return in 2026 is not possible, how realistic is a return in 2027?

Sheikh Hasina: May 17 is a deeply emotional and unforgettable day for me. After six years of exile, I returned to Bangladesh on this day in 1981. Even then, there were conspiracies against me. There were threats to my life. I returned home, ignoring every conspiracy and the threatening gaze of the rulers. Millions of people came down to the streets that day.

The question of return does not depend only on a fixed date. We are working to restore the democratic environment in Bangladesh, ensure freedom of expression, protect political rights, and bring back the rule of law. My absence does not mean my silence. We are active diplomatically, through international legal channels, and in the global media. I will return with my head held high, with the pride of restoring democracy in the

If there is a ban on the Awami League, how will your return be possible?

The love of the people is my greatest strength. All my life, I have worked for the welfare of the people of Bangladesh, whether in government or in opposition. The people of Bangladesh are still benefiting from the development carried out by the Awami League government.

In 1971, the then Pakistan government banned the Awami League. If bans could suppress the Awami League, Bangladesh itself would never have been born. This ban is a temporary display of force by those in power, but in reality, it reflects their fear. They are afraid of the Awami League because if the Awami League can carry out regular political activities, it will become difficult for them to continue their anti-state activities.

There is now discussion in different quarters about organizational purification within the Awami League.

The Awami League is a democratic party. Ideological workers are the lifeblood of this party, and they are the ones who determine its leadership. Whether you call it purification, reform, or renewal, it is a natural and regular process. This applies to every political party in the world.

As the largest political party in Bangladesh, allegations or complaints may arise against certain individuals connected to the party. We consider those matters with due seriousness. Even while in power, ministers and MPs of the Awami League who were involved in wrongdoing were brought before the law.

Political opponents often try to break the party in the name of purification or reform. I



Former Bangladesh Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina

want to say clearly that the Awami League has the capacity to purify itself. This purification will take place through the party's internal democratic process and through accountability to party workers and the people. It will not happen according to the prescription of conspirators.

At present, we are going through a natural process of purification. Those who are ideological leaders and workers are standing in their respective positions for the Awami League and for the country. Those who remain vocal for the Awami League despite all oppression and persecution are the true driving force of the party.

Will Awami League leaders who fled Bangladesh return home?

I disagree with the word "fled" because none of them left voluntarily. Since August 5, 2024, the state persecution that has descended upon Awami League leaders and activists is rare not only in the history of Bangladesh, but in world history. Nearly 600 of our leaders

and activists have been brutally killed. Even elderly people and mentally unwell individuals were not spared from the killings. Around 1.5 lakh leaders and activists have been arrested in false cases at different levels. Their homes and business establishments have been vandalized, burned, and occupied. Thousands of leaders and activists are still in prison. Around 150 leaders and activists have been killed inside jail. Prisoners are not being given even minimum legal rights. The oppressive ruling group is not even allowing people to attend the funeral prayers of their loved ones.

Bangladesh is now facing a severe economic crisis. If you were in leadership, how would this crisis have been resolved?

This is a very important issue. The foundation of Awami League politics is the welfare of the people. We implemented mega projects such as the Padma Bridge, Metro rail, Rooppur Nuclear Power Plant, Matarbari Deep Sea Port, Karnaphuli Tunnel, and Bang-

abandhu Satellite. Bangladesh became known around the world as a role model of development and as the rising tiger of Asia. But after power was seized through a meticulous design, the interim government led by Dr. Yunus destroyed the country's economy.

The country's economy is now facing a frightening situation. There is crisis of electricity, oil, gas, fertilizer, and even irrigation. Now let me answer your question: I can say with certainty that if I had been in charge of the government, this situation would not have arisen in the first place. On the other hand, Yunus seized power for his own interest.

Children are dying in Bangladesh after being infected with measles. Why has the current government failed?

The death of every child breaks my heart. I am a mother. The most unfortunate thing is that these children are dying from a disease we had almost brought to the point of elimination. If everything had

“May 17 is a deeply emotional and unforgettable day for me. After six years of exile, I returned to Bangladesh on this day in 1981”

remained on track, we would have declared Bangladesh measles-free in 2026.

During my government, Through the EPI program, in coordination with UNICEF and GAVI, we conducted regular vaccination programs and brought infectious diseases among children almost to the point of elimination. Bangladesh's vaccination program was a model for the world. In recognition of that, I received the GAVI Vaccine Hero award. During our time, maternal and child mortality rates were among the lowest in South Asia.

My question is this: even though there was sufficient allocation in the budget, why was the vaccination program disrupted? Why is there a shortage of medical supplies in hospitals? Where did the Tk 42,000 crore in the budget go?

What kind of steps is the Awami League taking for the release of jailed leaders, journalists, and intellectuals?

After August 5, 2024, the judiciary of the country has

turned into a political weapon. Supreme Court judges were forced to resign through mob pressure.

People appointed to the Supreme Court and the High Court are those who implement a party agenda. Lawyers are being attacked when they stand in court for our leaders and activists. Even in the elections of the lawyers' association, no one who believes in the ideals of the Liberation War was allowed to participate.

We are continuing the legal fight for the release of our leaders and activists at home and abroad. We are regularly sending reports and maintaining communication with the United Nations, the European Union, the Inter-Parliamentary Union, and various international organizations and human rights bodies.

How do you see the current government's stance towards India and its growing closeness with China and Pakistan? Is militancy now being encouraged?

The foundation of our foreign policy is friendship to all, malice towards none. The purpose of this friendship is public welfare, and its foundation is fairness and equality. This principle is embedded in our Constitution. In our country, anti-India politics has always been one of the main weapons of anti-liberation groups who have no ideological foundation. It is one of the tools of their politics. That is why they constantly practice anti-India rhetoric for narrow political purposes.

Our political opponents have always accused the Awami League of selling the country to India or signing anti-state agreements. But during the eighteen months of the interim government and under the cur-

rent government, they have not been able to produce even a single anti-state agreement. The people now understand this falsehood. When we came to power in 1996, we signed the Ganges Water Sharing Treaty. In 2014, through the settlement of maritime boundary disputes in an international court, we added nearly 20,000 square kms of maritime territory from India to Bangladesh's map. In 2015, through the historic Land Boundary Agreement, we permanently resolved the enclave problem between the two countries. The India-Bangladesh Friendship Pipeline that we established is now working as one of the lifelines of Bangladesh's energy sector during the global fuel crisis.

Are you seeking support from friendly countries and organizations around the world?

I seek the cooperation of all democratic states and organizations in the world. What is happening in Bangladesh today is not merely an internal matter of one country. It is connected with fundamental human rights and democratic values. If democracy fails in Bangladesh, if a fundamentalist state is established, if the culture of lawlessness continues, then the 18 crore people of Bangladesh will suffer. Its impact will also fall on regional and global security.

My message to the people of Bangladesh is: the Awami League will return, democracy will return. Every leader and activist of the Awami League will continue the struggle to build a democratic, inclusive, extremism-free, happy, and prosperous Bangladesh.

(This interview is based on a recorded telephone conversation of Sheikh Hasina with senior journalist and author Gautam Lahiri)

Business

India to continue buying Russian oil despite US sanctions: Official

Russian crude had risen to become core of India's oil basket since 2022

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: India has been purchasing Russian oil irrespective of US sanctions waivers and will continue to do so based on commercial viability and energy security needs, a senior petroleum ministry official said on Monday.

"Regarding the American waiver on Russia, I would like to emphasise that we have been purchasing from Russia earlier... before waiver also, during waiver also, and now also," Sujata Sharma, joint secretary in the petroleum ministry, told reporters at a media briefing.

Sharma said India's crude sourcing decisions were driven primarily by commercial considerations and adequate supply availability. "It is basically the commercial sense which should be there for us to purchase," she



'We have been purchasing from Russia earlier... before waiver also, during waiver also, and now also'

said, adding that there was no shortage of crude supplies and enough volumes had been tied up through long-term arrangements. A temporary US sanctions waiver allowing the sale and delivery of Russian sea-

Highlights

- » 'It is basically the commercial sense which should be there for us to purchase'
- » 'There was no shortage of crude supplies and enough volumes had been tied up through long-term arrangements'
- » 'Russian oil imports into India are expected to average close to 1.9 million bpd in May'

borne crude expired on May 16, marking the second time Washington has allowed the relief measure to lapse without clarity on an extension.

The general licence, first issued by the US Treasury

Department in mid-March and extended in April, was meant to ease pressure in global energy markets after the US-Israeli war against Iran triggered the largest-ever oil supply disruption.

"Whatever waiver or no waiver, it (availability) will not affect," Sharma said. Discounted Russian crude had risen to become the core of India's oil import basket since 2022, when Moscow's invasion of Ukraine triggered sweeping western sanctions and disrupted Russia's traditional export markets.

India, the world's third-largest crude importer and consumer, sharply increased purchases of Russian oil to take advantage of lower prices, helping domestic refiners manage elevated global energy costs.

US and European countries slapped sweeping sanctions on Russia for its February 2022

invasion but Russian oil itself was never sanctioned.

In recent months, US sanctioned certain Russian entities, including its largest crude oil suppliers — Rosneft and Lukoil — vessels and financial channels. Even then Russian remained off the sanctions list. This meant Russia continued to be a core supplier for India with procurement strictly ensuring no involvement of sanctioned sellers or intermediaries, use of non-sanctioned vessels, and fully compliant financial, insurance, and trading channels.

This led to a brief moderation in purchases last year but the waivers led to Indian refiners stepping up purchases again.

Russian oil imports into India are expected to average close to 1.9 million barrels/day (bpd) in May, according to data from Kpler, near record levels.

IOC's net profit rises to ₹36,802 crore in FY26

Revenue from ops rose to Rs 8,86,224 crore from Rs 8,45,513 crore in FY25

NEW DELHI: Indian Oil Corporation (IOC) reported a sharp rise in net profit to Rs 36,802 crore for FY2025-26, compared with Rs 12,962 crore in the previous financial year, driven by higher refining and marketing margins.

Revenue from operations rose 5 per cent to Rs 8,86,224 crore in FY26 from Rs 8,45,513 crore in FY25.

The company recorded its highest-ever annual crude throughput of 75.451 million metric tonnes (MMT) during the year, up from 71.564 MMT in FY25.

Refineries throughput for FY26 is 75.451 MMT with 107.4 per cent capacity utilisation as compared to 71.564 MMT in FY25 improving by 5 per cent.

IndianOil also achieved its highest-ever annual sales volume of 105.117 MMT compared with 100.292 MMT in the previous year. Domes-

tic petroleum sales volumes increased 4.8 per cent, outperforming the industry growth rate of 4.3 per cent.

The company's high-speed diesel (HSD) institutional sales volumes rose 21.2 per cent during the year against an industry growth of 7.2 per cent.

Domestic petrochemical sales volumes increased 4.4 per cent to 3.294 MMT in FY2025-26 from 3.155 MMT in FY2024-25.

IndianOil's cross-country pipeline network handled a combined throughput of 105.556 MMT during FY26, compared with 100.477 MMT in the previous fiscal, reflecting a 5 per cent increase.

The Board of Directors recommended a final dividend of Rs 1.25 per equity share of face value Rs 10 each.

This is in addition to the interim dividend of Rs 7 per equity share already paid during the financial year. **MP05T**

CAD to widen to 2.3% of GDP in FY27: HSBC

The balance of payments deficit is estimated to widen to \$65 billion in FY27

MUMBAI: India's current account deficit (CAD) is set to widen to 2.3 per cent of GDP in FY27 from 0.9 per cent in FY26, a foreign brokerage said on Monday.

The balance of payments (BoP) deficit is estimated to widen to \$65 billion in the current fiscal from the last fiscal year's \$35 billion, it said.

HSBC said it has assumed crude prices to average \$95 a barrel, and combined it with sensitivities in oil, gold, core goods, services trade and remittances to arrive at a current account deficit of 2.3 per cent of GDP in FY27 as against 0.9 per cent in FY26.

The BoP forecast has been made after growing through trends in portfolio inflows, foreign direct investment (FDI) flows, and external commercial borrowing (ECBs), it said.

The report also looked at forex reserves and opined that the nearly \$700 billion kitty seems sufficient from the traditional perspective, but suggested the need to look at it from a dynamic perspective, better for the current times of heightened risks amid recurring global shocks.

"Using a dynamic approach, we benchmark adequacy ratios against the lowest 10th percentile thresholds from India's own

history to make sure minimum support levels are available," it said.

While India is above all the thresholds currently, it would fall below the 10th percentile threshold if the estimates on the BoP lay out.

Around \$30 billion of extra forex reserves via extra inflows or current account savings would keep all buffers above the 10 per cent threshold, it said.

"There is a two-fold challenge: lower the CAD and attract capital inflows that are sustainable," it said, recommending policy actions including hiking pump prices

for fuels.

"There is evidence from 2022 that adequate pump diesel and petrol price increases can take care of two-thirds of the extra funds needed," it said.

Operationalising recently signed trade deals can raise India's growth prospects and bring back foreign direct investment flows, which have slowed, it said.

Additionally, unifying tax treatment across asset classes and right-sizing India's taxes on foreign investment relative to other economies can lead to market deepening and sustainable inflows, the report said. **P11**

TCS gives 6-8% salary hikes to India employees

NEW DELHI: Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) has rolled out annual salary hikes averaging 6-8 per cent for employees in India despite continued challenges in the IT sector, according to sources.

Top performers in the A+ rating category received hikes of over 10 per cent, while employees in the lowest rating bracket got increases of around 2-3 per cent. Overseas employees received hikes in the range of 2-4 per cent.

The hikes mark a return to TCS' normal appraisal cycle after delays last year due to macroeconomic uncertainties. The company had announced in April that salary increments would be implemented from the same month.

In a statement, TCS said it has also completed compensation restructuring for India-based employees in line with the new labour codes.

The revised salary structure aims to ensure compliance, standardise wage structures and protect take-home salaries while allowing tax flexibility.

In its latest annual report, TCS said junior and mid-level employees in India received average hikes of 4.5-7 per cent in FY26, with top performers getting double-digit increments. Total annual increases, including promotions and other revisions, ranged between 5-8 per cent.

Chief Human Resources Officer Sudeep Kunnimal had earlier said the hikes would be similar to last year's levels.

TCS had a workforce of 584,519 employees at the end of March 2026. **AGENCIES**

PM woos Swedish cos to invest in mfg, clean energy sectors in India

‘In the last 12 years, India has been working on the basic mantra of reforms, performance, and transformation,’ the prime minister said

GOTHENBURG: Asserting that India’s “reform express” is going at full speed, Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Sunday asked Swedish companies to enhance their presence in manufacturing, green hydrogen mission, clean energy and other sectors.

Wooring European companies, Modi highlighted the potential in five broad areas, including telecom and digital infrastructure, and said they can help in making India a global research and development hub.

Electronics, deep tech manufacturing, AI, green energy, infrastructure, mobility, urban transformation, healthcare and life science are among the other areas where the prime minister sought collaboration.

On an official visit to Sweden, Modi, addressing the European Round Table for Industry (ERT), stressed that there are opportunities for all companies and assured that various steps, including an institutional system, can be put in place for them to be part of India’s flagship projects in the coming years.

The next wave of technology innovation should be co-created in India, he noted.

“In the last 12 years, India



Prime Minister Narendra Modi with his Swedish counterpart Ulf Kristersson and others during an interaction with a group of the country's leading CEOs, in Gothenburg, Sweden

PTI

has been working on the basic mantra of reforms, performance, and transformation. And with the government’s political will, this Reform Express is moving forward at full speed,” Modi said at the roundtable as he mentioned the country’s young population, expanding middle class and infrastructure development.

Emphasising that India and Sweden are connected by the shared values of democracy, transparency, innovation and sustainability, Modi called for combining Sweden’s strengths in innovation and sustainability with India’s scale, talent and

growth momentum. Prime Minister of Sweden Ulf Kristersson, President of the European Commission Ursula von der Leyen, senior European industry leaders, and representatives from leading European and Indian companies also participated in the roundtable hosted by the Volvo Group.

In his address, Modi welcomed the growing momentum in India-EU relations, including the successful conclusion of negotiations of the landmark India-EU Free Trade Agreement (FTA).

He described the agreement as a transformative economic

Highlights

» Modi assured that various steps, including an institutional system, can be put in place for them to be part of India’s flagship projects

» The next wave of technology innovation should be co-created in India, he noted

» Modi welcomed the successful conclusion of negotiations of the landmark India-EU FTA

partnership that would create new opportunities in trade, technology, manufacturing, services and resilient supply chains.

“We have set an ambitious and strategic agenda at the level of governments... As Ursula von der Leyen had said, this is the mother of all deals. We are trying to implement this as soon as possible,” he said.

In January, India and the EU concluded the FTA.

He also noted that connectivity projects such as the India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor (IMEC) add new value to the India-Europe

business partnership.

Modi underlined that India today represents one of the world’s most attractive destinations for investment, innovation and manufacturing.

He highlighted India’s rapid economic growth, next-generation economic reforms, ease of doing business, focus on governance, expanding digital public infrastructure, vibrant manufacturing ecosystem, and rapidly transforming infrastructure sector.

Prime Minister Modi reiterated India’s vision of “Design for India, Make in India and Export from India” and invited European companies to deepen their engagement with India as a trusted and reliable economic partner.

He also underlined the importance of talent mobility, education and skill partnerships between India and Europe. He highlighted India’s young and skilled workforce as a major strength for future global economic growth and emphasised the need to deepen people-to-people ties and innovation partnerships.

The prime minister suggested holding the India-Europe CEOs Round-table annually and also creating an India Desk at ERT. AGENCIES

Rupee drops 39 paise to record low of 96.20 against US dollar

On equity market front, BSE Sensex rose 77.05 pts to 75,315.04, while NSE Nifty jumped 6.45 pts to 23,649.95

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: The Indian rupee weakened further and closed at a record low of 96.20, down 39 paise against the US dollar on Monday, pressured by rising crude oil prices on the back of ongoing geopolitical tensions and a strong dollar.

Forex traders said the global market sentiments continue to dampen amid simmering tensions between the US and Iran.

Moreover, emerging market economies, including India, continue to feel the pressure of rising crude oil prices, as elevated rates increase the outflows of US dollars, along with the outflows already happening due to FPIs, traders said.

At the interbank foreign exchange market, the rupee opened at 96.19, then fell further to 96.39 against the US dollar, registering a fall of 58 paise from its previous close.

At the end of Monday’s trading session, the rupee was quoted at 96.20, down 39 paise from its previous close.

On Friday, the Indian rupee crashed below the 96/\$mark on Friday before closing at an all-time low of 95.81 against the US dollar.

“We expect the rupee to trade with a negative bias amid a strong dollar and rising US treasury yields. Ongoing geopolitical tensions and FII outflows may also pressure



The dollar index was trading at 99.14, lower by 0.14 per cent due to simmering Iran tensions

the rupee.

“However, any intervention by the RBI and certain restrictions on the import of gold and silver may support the rupee at lower levels. USDINR spot price is expected to trade in a range of 96 to 96.60,” Anuj Choudhary, Research Analyst, Commodities Research, Mirae Asset Sharekhan, said.

The dollar index, which gauges the greenback’s strength against a basket of six currencies, was trading at 99.14, lower by 0.14 per cent due to simmering Iran tensions.

Meanwhile, on equity market front, the 30-share BSE Sensex increased by 77.05 points, or 0.10 per cent, to settle at 75,315.04.

A total of 3,034 stocks declined while 1,264 advanced and 194 remained unchanged on the BSE.

The 50-share NSE Nifty edged higher by 6.45 points, or 0.03 per cent, to end at 23,649.95.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, was trading up 0.65 per cent at \$109.97 per barrel in futures trade.

Foreign Institutional Investors remained net buyers for the second straight session, purchasing equities worth Rs 1,329.17 crore on Friday, according to exchange data.

India’s forex reserves jumped \$6.295 billion to \$696.988 billion during the week ended May 8, the Reserve Bank said on Friday. Overall reserves had dropped \$7.794 billion to \$690.693 billion in the previous reporting week.

Meanwhile, within days of levying high customs duties on precious metals, the government on Saturday imposed import curbs on silver by putting the metal under a licensed regime for inbound shipments.

The government, on May 13, hiked import duty on precious metals — gold and silver — from 6 per cent to 15 per cent. The effective duty (including 3 per cent IGST) is over 18 per cent.

It was hiked to control the outflow of forex by curbing non-essential imports.

RBI elevates Gunveer Singh as ED

MUMBAI: The RBI on Monday appointed Gunveer Singh as Executive Director with effect from May 18. Before his elevation, Singh was serving as Chief General Manager-in-Charge of the Department of Payment and Settlement Systems.

As Executive Director, he will continue to oversee the Department of Payment and Settlement Systems, the RBI said in a statement.

Singh has more than three decades of experience at the central bank across payment and settlement systems, banking and non-banking supervision, risk monitoring and government banking. He has also worked as a payment systems expert at the Central Bank of Oman. He is a Chartered Accountant and a Cost and Works Accountant. MPOST

NTPC’s installed power generation capacity crosses 90 GW mark

NEW DELHI: State-owned power giant NTPC on Monday announced that its installed electricity generation capacity has surpassed 90 GW after completing trial operations of Unit 2 (800 MW) at its arm Patratu Vidyut Utpadan Nigam.

The achievement marks another important step towards building a sustainable and energy-secure future for India, a company statement said.

The milestone was achieved after the successful completion of trial operations of Unit 2 (800 MW) of Patratu Vidyut Utpadan Nigam Ltd (PVUNL), a subsidiary project, comprising 3X800 MW units.

Patratu Vidyut Utpadan Nigam Ltd was incorporated on October 15, 2015.

It is a joint venture between a subsidiary of NTPC Ltd, which holds a 74 per cent stake, and



Jharkhand Bijli Vitran Nigam Ltd, which has the remaining 26 per cent share.

PVUNL is committed to providing reliable and affordable power in an efficient and environment-friendly manner through the adoption of new technologies and optimal utilisation of resources.

With the addition, the NTPC Group now operates more than 90 GW of installed capacity across the country, according to the statement.

The company also has around 32 GW of capacity under construction. MPOST

NTPC has set a target of achieving 149 GW total installed capacity by 2032, including 60 GW from renewable energy sources.

In its continuous efforts to boost renewable energy footprints, NTPC added 5,488 MW of renewable capacity in FY26 across solar, wind, and pumped storage projects (PSP), accelerating its momentum on the journey of Viksit Bharat.

NTPC’s diversified energy portfolio includes thermal, hydro, solar, and wind power projects, ensuring a reliable, affordable, and sustainable electricity supply across India. In addition to power generation, NTPC has expanded into several new business areas, including e-mobility, battery storage, pumped hydro storage, waste-to-energy, nuclear power, and green hydrogen solutions. MPOST

NEW DELHI: Essar Energy Transition (EET) has completed the Pre-Front End Engineering Design (Pre-FEED) stage for its Stanlow Methanol to Jet (MtJ) project, which is expected to become one of the UK’s largest sustainable aviation fuel (SAF) production hubs.

Integrated with the Stanlow refinery infrastructure, the planned facility will produce over 200,000 tonnes per annum (tpa) of advanced SAF using nearly 550,000 tpa of renewable e-methanol and bio-methanol feedstock.

The project will enable on-site blending of SAF with conventional jet fuel produced by Essar Energy Transition Fuels. Through existing export infrastructure, including the Manchester Jet, Midlands and UKOP pipeline systems, along



The project will enable on-site blending of SAF with conventional jet fuel produced by Essar Energy Transition Fuels

with road and marine distribution routes, the fuel can be supplied directly to major UK airports and airlines. Renewable e-methanol and

bio-methanol feedstock will be sourced from domestic and international suppliers. Existing import and storage infrastructure at Stanlow Terminals Ltd is expected to reduce capital expenditure and improve access to low-cost, low-carbon feedstock.

The Pre-FEED stage, partly funded through an up to £2.5 million grant under the UK Government Department for Transport’s Advanced Fuel Fund, was completed in partnership with Genesis. The study evaluated site suitability, technology readiness, refinery integration, carbon intensity and environmental compliance.

According to the company, the study confirmed that the Stanlow Manufacturing Complex can accommodate the facility and identified no major barriers related to permitting

and approvals. It also highlighted strong market interest in renewable methanol supply and integration opportunities that could lower costs and emissions.

The project will now target participation in the UK SAF Revenue Certainty Mechanism process. Front-end engineering design (FEED) is scheduled for later this year, while the Final Investment Decision (FID) is targeted by early 2028.

EET said the project forms a key part of its multi-billion-dollar energy transition investment programme in North West England and will support high-skilled employment. The UK’s SAF mandate requires 22 per cent of total jet fuel consumption to come from SAF by 2040, with the Stanlow project expected to play a major role in meeting that target. MPOST

BoI hikes rates on its medium & long term FD

NEW DELHI: Bank of India (BoI), one of the leading public sector banks in India, has increased interest rates on medium and long-term Fixed Deposits of less than Rs 3 crore for tenures ranging from 1 to 3 years, effective from Monday.

The revised rates for 1-year to less than 2 years is 6.50 per cent per annum, for 2 years to less than 3 years @6.60 per cent per annum, and for 3-year @6.70 per cent per annum.

Senior Citizens and Super Senior Citizens will get an additional interest 0.50 per cent and 0.65 per cent per annum for deposits with a maturity of 6 months to less than 3 years.

For FDs of 3 years and above, Senior Citizens and Super Senior Citizens will get an additional 0.75 per cent per annum and 0.90 per cent per annum over and above the applicable ROI.

Further, non-callable deposits (above Rs 1 crore with minimum tenure of 1 year) will earn an additional 0.15 per cent per annum Loan against Fixed Deposit and Premature Withdrawal options are available only on callable deposits.

Customers can open Fixed Deposits at any Bank of India branch or through the BOI Omni Neo App/ internet banking. MPOST

NSE starts live trading in Gold Receipts

NEW DELHI: National Stock Exchange (NSE) of India on Monday commenced live trading in Electronic Gold Receipts (EGRs), a step towards creating a regulated spot gold market in the country.

The exchange said the product has received encouraging participation from market players and the wider ecosystem.

Currently, vaulting and collection centres are operational in Ahmedabad and Mumbai. Four more centres in Delhi, Kolkata, Chennai and Bengaluru became operational on Monday. NSE plans to expand the network in phases to around 120 centres across the country. MPOST

Bajaj Auto Foundation & VIT sign MoU to set up BEST Centre with investment of ₹15 crore

VELLORE: Bajaj Auto Foundation and Vellore Institute of Technology have signed a Memorandum of Understanding to establish the Bajaj Engineering Skills Training (BEST) Centre on the VIT campus with an investment of Rs 15 crore.

The centre will provide advanced training in Electronics Manufacturing Systems (EMS) and E-Mobility to bridge the skill gap between industry and academia. It aims to equip engineering and diploma students, including final-year students, with hands-on industry-relevant skills for the manufacturing and automotive sectors, particularly the growing electric vehicle and electronics manufacturing ecosystem.



Speaking at the event, Sudhakar Gudipati, Vice President-CSR, Bajaj Auto Foundation, said the rapidly evolving manufacturing and automotive industries require a highly skilled workforce and added that more BEST centres would be established across India.

VIT Founder and Chancellor Dr. G. Viswanathan said the partnership would create a cutting-edge training environment and provide students with a competitive advantage in the job market.

The centre will have two verticals — E-Mobility and EMS. The E-Mobility segment will offer training in EV fundamentals, battery technology, battery management systems and EV charging systems, while the

EMS vertical will focus on electronic design, PCB design and assembly, surface mount technology and quality inspection. Ramesh V, Head-CSR, Bajaj Auto Foundation, highlighted scholarship schemes for socio-economically disadvantaged students.

The ceremony began with a welcome address by Dr. P. Kuppan and concluded with a vote of thanks by Dr. S. Sivanantham. It was attended by Dr. Sankar Viswanathan, Dr. Sekar Viswanathan, Dr. Sandhya Pentareddy, Ms. Kadhambari S. Viswanathan, Dr. V. S. Kanchana Bhaaskaran, Dr. Partha Sharathi Mallick and Dr. T. Jayabharathi. MPOST

ITC benefits farmers via integrated agri-ecosystem, emerges as India’s leading exporter of organic spices

ITC’s spices processing facility in Guntur is among Asia’s largest processed spices units

NEW DELHI: ITC Limited said its integrated agri-ecosystem has benefited over 31,800 spice farmers across 2.2 lakh acres by improving productivity, sustainability and export opportunities through technology, advisory services and market access.

The company said it emerged as India’s leading exporter of organic spices in 2025, supported by its spices processing facility in Guntur, Andhra Pradesh, which is among Asia’s largest processed spices units. Spread over six



acres, the facility has a processing capacity of more than 20,000 metric tonnes annually and handles over 15 spice varieties. ITC said the facility supports an end-to-end organic

spices value chain with specialised processing, logistics and packaging infrastructure, along with barcode-based traceability from farm to export. S Ganesh Kumar, Divisional Chief Executive, Agri Business, ITC Ltd, said the company’s strategy focuses on expanding value-added agriculture products while improving farmer incomes through climate-smart practices, digital tools and market linkages.

ITC’s farmer development programme is based on Integrated Pest Management,

Integrated Crop Management and organic farming models. According to a study by IDH, farmers associated with these programmes recorded a 42 per cent increase in incomes over 10 years due to better yields, reduced costs and improved market access.

The company also leverages its ITCMAARS platform to provide AI-powered advisory, weather alerts and pest management solutions to over 18,250 farmers through Farmer Producer Organisations. MPOST

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE



NBCC (India) Ltd signed an MoU with State Bank of India (SBI) on May 15, 2026, for extending a comprehensive Corporate Salary Package (CSP) to the employees of the company. The MoU was signed by Jyostna Rani Moharana, DGM (SBI) and Sanjeev Kumar, CGM (HRM), NBCC in the presence of Shri Anjeev Kumar Jain, Director (Finance), Sh. Ashwin P. Kulkarni, DGM and senior officials from both organisations. The agreement further provides financial protection benefits including Personal & Accident Insurance, Permanent/Temporary Disability Group Term Life Insurance, Health insurance, Top-up facilities, Rebate in loan facility etc.



Central Bank of India on May 16, 2026 organised ‘Mega MSME Credit Outreach Program’ at Shiv Mandir Agarwal Dharmsala, Purani Anaj Mandi, Narela, under the guidance of our esteemed Regional Head, Delhi South, Munish Kumar, DGM, Zonal Office, Anil Kumar, and DRH, Delhi South, Mandeep Kumar. During the event, MSME loan sanction letters were distributed to customers by the Regional Head, marking a significant step towards strengthening support for the MSME sector. Camps were also held at different locations by branches under Delhi South and loan amounting to Rs 127 crore were sanctioned.

Pat on the back for Kishan

Ishan, Cummins shine to take SRH into playoffs with win over CSK

CHENNAI: Ishan Kishan struck a fluent 70 after Pat Cummins displayed his mastery over length and pace with a three-wicket burst as Sunrisers Hyderabad ensured an IPL 2026 playoff berth with a smooth five-wicket victory over Chennai Super Kings here on Monday.

Chasing 181 was never going to be easy on a slowish Chepauk track. But Kishan, who hammered seven fours and three sixes in his 47-ball knock, and an equally enterprising Heinrich Klaasen (47 off 26 balls) added 75 runs for the third wicket, powering Hyderabad to 181 for five in 19 overs.

SRH now have 16 points with a game in hand -- good enough to carry them to the playoffs and the night's result meant that Gujarat Titans (16 points) also marched into the knockouts.

Royal Challengers Bengaluru (18 points) have already sealed their place in the play-offs, leaving other contenders to fight it out for the lone remaining place.

The Super Kings, who have 12 points from 13 matches, also are not yet completely out of the race to the knockouts.

Cutting back to the match, the Sunrisers did not have a



Ishan Kishan hit three fours and seven sixes to make 70 off 47 balls

PFI

particularly bright beginning to the chase, losing Travis Head early.

Abhishek Sharma too struggled for his timing, crawling to a 21-ball 26 as SRH could not find momentum in the Power Play, which they ended on 45 for one.

But once Klaasen, who was dropped on 18 by Spencer Johnson off Noor Ahmad, joined Kishan, the complexion of the game changed.

The duo neutralised CSK spinners -- Akeal Hossain and Ahmad -- with exemplary

shot-making and foot work during their alliance as SRH closed in on the target.

Kishan completed his 50 in 37 balls but lost Klaasen to a brilliant stumping by Sanju Samson off Ahmad. However, the left-hander, who played some brilliant shots around the field, converted that fifty into something more substantial to drive his side's charge.

However, he was not there to take SRH home as he fell to Anshul Kamboj but by then the 2016 champions needed just six runs to win. Earlier, pacer

Cummins displayed his absolute control over his craft, but a collective batting effort helped CSK reach a competitive 180/7.

The Hyderabad skipper (3/28) struck at crucial junctures of the match to ensure that CSK would not embark on a lopsided run after the home side elected to bat. Samson gave a thunderous start to the Super Kings, smashing Nitish Kumar Reddy for 6, 4, 4, to eke out 17 runs in the first over. Samson handed an equally harsh treatment to Praful Hinge in the next over.

AGENCIES

Hardik trains at full intensity

KOLKATA: Mumbai Indians skipper Hardik Pandya trained at full intensity during his side's practice session here on Monday, indicating his return for their IPL match against Kolkata Knight Riders on Wednesday.

Pandya, who had missed MI's last three matches due to a back spasm, was among the first players to get off the team bus and looked relaxed as he went through an extended bowling and batting session at the nets.

The all-rounder bowled at full tilt and batted fluently, drawing considerable attention during Mumbai Indians' training ahead of the KKR clash. Pandya last played in MI's away match against Chennai Super Kings on May 2 before being sidelined with the injury. He did not travel to Dharamsala for MI's six-wicket win over Punjab Kings.

AGENCIES

JAIPUR: Their playoff hopes hanging by a thread, the Rajasthan Royals will need an all-round improvement against the out-of-contention Lucknow Super Giants to stay alive in the Indian Premier League here on Tuesday.

At the high-scoring Sawai Mansingh Stadium, Royals are yet to win a game this season and the final fixture here is a do or die one for the home team.

Following Tuesday's fixture, the Royals' last game is also against a vanquished outfit -- the Mumbai Indians.

In Delhi on Sunday night, RR should have out-batted Delhi Capitals but a lower order collapse cost them the match in which their fielding and bowling was also fairly ordinary.

The Royals have been relying heavily on 15-year-old Vaibhav Sooryavanshi for flying starts but the youngster has not got enough support from Yashasvi Jaiswal at the other end. Dhruv Jurel has played some sublime knocks but the one on Sunday night was a rather subdued one with wickets falling at the other end.

Captain Riyan Parag was underwhelming in the first half of the IPL but has picked up pace in the recent games. He would want his side to be much more clinical in the last



The Royals have depended on Vaibhav Sooryavanshi for flying starts

PFI

Royals too have been guilty of grassing easy catches in a season of poor fielding

five overs with the bat.

The catching and fielding have generally been poor in the IPL and Royals too have been guilty of grassing easy chances.

Post the loss to Delhi Capitals, Parag had expressed his frustration with the team not playing to its potential in the business end of the tournament.

"The fielding was poor. If we keep on playing like this, we shouldn't be in contention for the top four," Parag had stated while acknowledging that the

team's fate is no longer in its own hands.

"I think that's depending on a lot of other teams as well. That is not how I like to lead. That is not how I like to speak to my team as well," he admitted when talking about the playoff chances "So if we do not qualify, it's our fault. No-one else's. And yeah, next two games, we'll see what we can do better and hopefully get two wins," added Parag, who has been nursing a hamstring niggle.

LSG, dealing with issues of their own, come into the game on the back of a rare win in the tournament. They beat Chennai Super Kings at home on May 15 and would be looking to play party-poopers in their remaining two games (last one against Punjab Kings).

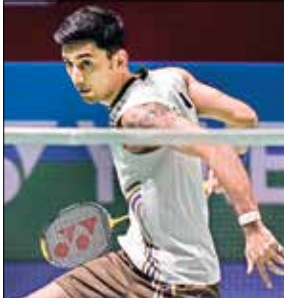
AGENCIES

Shuttlers out for revenge against French at Malaysia Masters

KUALA LUMPUR: A fresh India-versus-France battle awaits in the men's singles competition and the Indian shuttlers will look to avenge their recent Thomas Cup semifinal defeat when the Malaysia Masters Super 500 begins on Tuesday. India had won a bronze medal after suffering a 0-3 loss to France in the Thomas Cup semifinals in Horsens, Denmark earlier this month, losing all three singles matches.

This week, three Indian singles players will once again face French opponents and will be eager to turn the tables.

While star Indian shuttler Lakshya Sen, who had missed the Thomas Cup tie due to an elbow injury, will open against Indonesia's Moh Zaki Ubaidillah, Tharun Manneppalli will take on France's Toma Junior



Popov, Kiran George will face seventh seed Alex Lanier, and HS Prannoy will meet Christo Popov. S Sankar Muthusamy Subramanian will have to come through the qualifying rounds.

In men's doubles, Hariharan Amsakarunan and MR Arjun will be keen to make a statement when they face the seventh-seeded French pair of Christo Popov and Toma Junior Popov.

AGENCIES

India hosts landmark WFADS Asian Championship Cup 2026

NEW DELHI: In a landmark moment for the growth of dance sport in Asia, the World Federation of Acrobatic Dances and Dance Sports (WFADS), in association with the National Federation of Acrobatics and Dance Sport India (NFADI), successfully hosted the WFADS Asian Championship Cup 2026 at Talkatora Stadium, New Delhi, on May 8.

The championship marked the large-scale introduction of Acrobatic Rock & Roll and Acro Swing in India, combining athletic excellence with artistic performance in a dynamic competitive format.

The event was graced by Chief Guest Minister Ashish Sood, while Guests of Honour included Gaurav ji and Khushbu ji from Manthan Gymnastics Academy. Special Guests present at the occasion included Shri Bikramjeet Singh Cheema, Vice President BJP Punjab, HS Phoolka, Advocate and former Member of the Punjab Legislative Assembly, and Manoj Sethi.

Jasmeet K. Shan, president, NFADI said: "The WFADS Asian Championship Cup 2026 is not just an event -- it is the beginning of a movement that positions India at the forefront of a globally recognized dance



Event showcased electrifying performances and extraordinary talent across multiple categories

sport. By introducing Acrobatic Rock & Roll and Acro Swing at scale, we are creating a dynamic ecosystem for athletes, performers, and youth across the country. This platform bridges sport and art, discipline and expression, while opening pathways for international recognition and Olympic ambition. India is ready to embrace this revolution."

The event showcased electrifying performances and

extraordinary talent across multiple categories, as athletes from across Asia delivered world-class routines in Acrobatic Rock & Roll and Acro Swing. Winner categories were as follows: Rock and Roll Formation Women: Zhasar -- Kazakhstan; Rock and Roll A Class Adults: Enthtur Chinguun & Shanina Ekaterina -- Mongolia; Rock and Roll B Class Adults: Yashanov Kirill & Dossaliyeva Ayana -- Kazakhstan; Acro Swing Adults: Samir Kumar & Priyanshi Mathur -- India. The championship also saw participation from nearly 100 international athletes representing Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Russia, Mongolia, Vietnam, China, and India, highlighting the growing global appeal of acrobatic dance sports in the region.

MPOST

Carvajal to leave Real Madrid at the end of season

MADRID: Veteran defender Dani Carvajal will not return to Real Madrid next season, the club said on Monday.

Madrid said the club and the player "have agreed to bring an end to a wonderful chapter as a player of our club at the conclusion of the current season."

Carvajal's contract ends in June. The 34-year-old right back joined Madrid in 2002 and has played 23 seasons with the Spanish powerhouse -- 10 in the academy and 13 with the main squad. "Dani Carvajal is a legend and a symbol of Real Madrid and its academy," club president Floren-

tino Pérez said. "His image alongside our beloved and remembered Alfredo Di Stéfano laying the first stone of Ciudad Real Madrid will forever remain in the hearts of all madridistas and in the history of our club. Carvajal has always exemplified the values of Real Madrid."

AGENCIES

Enters French Open on a 29-match win streak

ROME: From the California desert to Miami; Monte Carlo to Madrid; and the red clay of Rome, too, nobody has been able to beat Jannik Sinner for three full months.

By sweeping the first five Masters 1000 tournaments of the year, the top-ranked Sinner has dominated tennis like few other players have in the sport's recent history while amassing a 29-match winning streak.

And yet now the stakes are rising for Sinner as he attempts to complete a career Grand Slam by winning the French Open.

The clay-court Grand Slam, which starts on Sunday in Paris, is the only major that Sinner hasn't won. A couple of hours after becoming the first Italian man to win the Italian Open in 50 years on Sunday, Sinner's focus was already pivoting toward Roland Garros.

"We don't have much time to realize what we're accomplishing," Sinner said. "I said it before the start of the year: My main goal is and remains Paris."

"What we've done here and the rest of the year is incredible. I realize that. But mentally I know that now I've got to do all the right things. It's

Sinner supremacy



Jannik Sinner is in the form of his life

AP

necessary to rest, but I also need to stay in form because soon my most important tournament of the year is approaching. I don't want to put too much pressure on myself."

The pressure on Sinner has heightened with his only real rival, Carlos Alcaraz, currently sidelined due to a right wrist injury that will keep the Spaniard out of the French Open. Alcaraz became the youngest man to complete a career Grand

Slam when he won the Australian Open in February at 22. The 24-year-old Sinner has matched Pete Sampras' 29-match winning streak from 1994 for the fifth longest run in the ATP Tour era (since 1990). Novak Djokovic holds the record with 43 straight match wins in 2010-11. With his Rome title, Sinner has already become the second man after Djokovic to win all nine Masters 1000 events.

AGENCIES

NORTHERN RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE
By CWM/Principal/STTC, acting for and on behalf of The President of India invites E- Tenders against following tender closing date **10.06.2026, 15:30**. Bidders will be able to submit their original/ revised bids upto closing date and time only. Manual offers are not allowed against this tender, and any such manual offer received shall be ignored. Contractors are allowed to make payments against this tender towards tender document cost and earnest money only through online payment modes available on IREPS portal like net banking, debit card, credit card etc. Manual payments through Demand draft, Banker's cheque, Deposit receipts, FDR etc. are not allowed.

Item	Description
Name of Work	Augmentation of IT Infrastructure and Strengthening of Data Networks at STTC GZB in Northern Railway.
Tender No	SWS-GZB-PLG-2025-26
Advertised Cost	₹60,60,514.41/-
Earnest Money	₹121200.00/-
Bidding start date	27.05.2026
Bidding Closing date & Time	10.06.2026 upto 15:30 Hrs
Website	www.ireps.gov.in

SERVING CUSTOMER WITH A SMILE 1656/2026

कार्यपालक अभियन्ता का कार्यालय लघु सिंचाई प्रमंडल, राँची।
कमरा नं० 302, तुलसी तल्ला, अभियंत्रण भवन, कदहरी चौक, राँची- 834001
ई-मेल - eemidran-cemr-jhr@nic.in, midranchi2018@gmail.com
फोन नं० - 0651-3512781

पत्रांक..... / राँची, दिनांक / / 2026

शुक्ति-पत्र

कार्यपालक अभियन्ता, लघु सिंचाई प्रमंडल, राँची का पत्रांक-395 दिनांक-04.05.2026 द्वारा e-Tender Reference No. WRD/MID/ 04/BD/ (SLI) 2026-27, PR 379050 Minor Irrigation (26-27):D दिनांक 06.05.2026 को प्रकाशित निविदा में निम्न प्रकार संशोधन किया जाता है:-

क्र०	पूर्व में अंकित निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या	संशोधित निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना संख्या
1	WRD/MID/04/BD/(SLI) 2026-27	WRD/MID/RANCHI/BD/SLI-04/2026-27

निविदा की शेष सभी शर्तें पूर्वतः बनी रहेंगी।

विश्वासपात्र
कार्यपालक अभियन्ता, लघु सिंचाई प्रमंडल, राँची।
PR 380090 (Minor Irrigation) 26-27 (D)

NORTHERN RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE
Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/Traction Distribution, DRM's Office, State Entry Road, New Delhi for & on behalf of President of India, invites open e-tender for the under noted work:

1. Name of Work with its location	Augmentation/Replacement of Catenary wire over Delhi Division (7th Phase).
2. Approx. Cost of work	Rs. 1,80,29,018.38/-
3. Earnest Money Deposit	Rs. 3,60,600/-
4. E-Tender Bid Online Submission Period	29.05.2026 (00.00 Hrs.) to 12.06.2026 (15.00 Hrs.)
5. E-Tender Bid Submission End Date & E-Tender Open Date & Time	12.06.2026,(15.00 hrs.)
6. Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen	www.ireps.gov.in

09-TRD-NDLS-2026-27 Dated 18.05.2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 1657/26

Chhattisgarh State Industrial Development Corporation Limited
(A Government of Chhattisgarh Undertaking)
(ISO 9001: 2015 Certified)
1st Floor, Udyog Bhawan, Ring Road No.1, Telibandha, Raipur (C.G.) - 492006
CIN: U45203CT1981SG001853, PAN: AABCM6288N, GST Regn. No. 22AABCM6288N52Y
Phone: 0771-6621000, Fax: 0771-2583794
Website: www.csidc.in, Email address: csidc.cg@nic.in, csidc_raipur@yahoo.com

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (2nd Call)
(Through e-Procurement Portal Only)
NIT No. 16/CSIDC/E.E./Division-I/2026-27/ Raipur, Dated 15/05/2026
Chhattisgarh State Industrial Development Corporation Ltd., Raipur (CSIDC), a Government of Chhattisgarh Undertaking constituted under the Companies Act, engaged in Industrial Infrastructure Development & Other Related Activities in the State invites online tender for the following work :-

S.No.	Name of Work	Registered Contractor in CGPWD or in appropriate class in other dept't.	Probable Amount of Contract (PAC) (INR Crore)	Last Date for Submission of tender
A	Infrastructure development works i/c roads, drainage, culverts, water supply system & street light for Proposed New Industrial area: Food Park area at Village- Champa, Tehsil- Kartal, District- Korba (C.G.)	Class-B & Above	8.48	01/06/2026

The tender document containing detailed terms & conditions, scope of works and other details can be downloaded from the web portal (website) <https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in> from 15/05/2026 Time 17:01 and shall be submitted online only. Amendment in tender, if any, will only be uploaded on the website and shall not be published in any newspaper.

NOTE: The interested tenderers for online submission of tender may contact CG e-Proc Helpdesk. Operated by Mjunction Services Limited, they may reach Helpdesk using 18004199140 (therein press 2 for CG e-Proc) or you can email them at Helpdesk.eproc@cgswan.gov.in

samvad 47842/4

Executive Engineer
Division-I

Deepika, Atanu out of Asian Games squad

SONEPAT: Four-time Olympian Deepika Kumari, former India No. 1 Atanu Das and multiple Asian Games medalist Abhishek Verma failed to make India's archery squad for the Asian Games in Japan after a gruelling three-day selection trial which concluded in windy conditions here on Monday.

Teenagers Kirti Sharma and Kumkum Mohod emerged as the biggest gainers in the women's recurve section, while Olympian Ankita Bhakat sealed the third and final berth after defeating Deepika in a shoot-off.

In the compound section that fetched all the five gold medals on offer in the last Asian Games, veteran Jyothi Surekha Vennam remained the only experienced face to make the cut.

Abhishek endured a disappointing campaign and finished last among the top-eight archers. India's top compound archer and world No. 7 Rishabh Yadav also missed out, finishing fourth behind Andhra Pradesh's Thirumuru Ganesh Mani Ratnam.

The trials, held at the SAI centre here, selected India's squad for the Asian Games to be held in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan, in September-October and the third and fourth stages of the World Cup. The biggest surprise came in the women's recurve section where 19-year-old Kirti topped the trials with 13.5 points, ahead of Maharashtra's rising archer Kumkum Mohod, while Ankita secured the third spot.

Both Ankita and Deepika were tied on 10.75 points after three rounds spread across three days before Ankita prevailed in the decider.

Deepika will thus miss a second successive Asian Games. She had also missed the 2022 Hangzhou edition after the birth of her daughter.

Despite a decorated career with multiple World Cup medals and a Commonwealth Games title, Deepika is yet to win an individual medal at the Asian Games in three appearances since 2010.

Her best result remains the team bronze medal from the Guangzhou Games.



NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE
Divisional Railway Manager (Works) N.C. Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.
E-Tender No. : JHS-ENG-GH-2026-118
Description of work : Virangana Lakshmbai Jhansi-JHS/E-Renovation and upgradation of the DSA Football ground of Jhansi Division along with construction of jogging/walking track.
Approx Cost : 12978204.97
Date of closing Tender : 09/06/2026 at 15:00 hrs.
Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter, : 06 Months
Tender online can be submitted up to 15:00 hrs on 09.06.2026
For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.irops.gov.in
North central railways @www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @CPRONCR

NORTHERN RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE
Invitation of Tender through E-Tendering (E-Procurement System)
Tender Notice No. & Date : 32-W-BR-PSC-SLAB-DL3 DATE - 15.05.2026
Name of work with its location : Casting of PSC slab Replacement of steel girders upto 12.2m with PSC slabs of Bridge No-67A UP & DN (4x12.2m), 79 UP & DN (2x12.2m) on DLI UMB section & Bridge No. 55 UP & DN (3x9.15m) on DLI-BT1 section of DLI division
Approx cost of work : ₹3,09,09,371.58/- Amount of Earnest Money : ₹7,80,200.00/-
Completion period of the work : (06) Six Months
Date & time of submission of tender & opening of tender : Upto 15.00 hrs. 10.06.2026 Opening of tender after 15.00 hrs. on same day
Note: Above tender is available on website, IREPS site i.e www.irops.gov.in, where complete details of tender can be seen & downloaded.
SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 1642/2026

Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER PMGSY JKRRDA JAMMU
Phone No.: 0191-2470284, Fax No.: 0191-2479335
CORRIGENDUM- 02
Sub:- Change of critical dates of bids / extension of Notice Inviting Tenders.
Ref:- This office e-NIT No. CEJ/PMGSY/809 of 2026-27 Dated 20-04-2026 issued vide endorsement No:- CEJ/PMGSY/1359-1433 Dated 20-04-2026.
Due to technical reason, the critical dates of above mentioned NIT have been changed as per details given below:-

S.No	Particular	Original date	Revised date
1	Closing date of down loading bidding documents.	16-05-2026 (05.00 PM)	20-05-2026 (05.00 PM)
2	Dead line for submission of bids in electronic format on the web site.	16-05-2026 (05.00 PM)	20-05-2026 (05.00 PM)
3	Time and date of opening of received bids on the website.	19-05-2026 (11.00 AM)	21-05-2026 (02.00 PM)

Rest all other terms and conditions will remain same as already advertised.
Chief Engineer PMGSY (JKRRDA) Jammu
Dated:- 16-05-2026
DIP No: DIP/J-2187/26

Govt. of Maharashtra
FOREST DEPARTMENT
OFFICE OF THE DY. DIRECTOR (BUFFER), T.A.T.R. CHANDRAPUR
Rambag Forest Colony, Mull Road, Chandrapur
E-mail: dyefcha@gmail.com, Phone (07172) 252232
INVITATION FOR E-TENDER
Notice No.03/2026-27
On behalf of the Dy. Director (Buffer), Tadoba Andhari Tiger Reserve, Chandrapur invites e-Tender in the prescribed forms (Technical & Financial) from eligible bidders as per terms and conditions of the bid for Design, Supply, Installation, Commissioning, Operation and Maintenance for 03 Year of Biodegrader Package Sewage Treatment Plant including all Civil and Electrical Works at Various Locations in PALASGAON RANGE in Buffer Division, TATR Chandrapur (Total - 18 Nos.) (Including GST Amount) 1) Capacity 1.2 KLD - 10 Nos. 2) Capacity 2.4 KLD - 06 Nos., 3) Capacity 3.6 KLD - 01 Nos. 4) Capacity 6.0 KLD - 01 Nos.
1. Detail of e-Tender are given in Tender Document, which will be available on Website under <http://mahatenders.gov.in> The copy of the Tender Document can be downloaded.
2. Online bidding will be done on <http://mahatenders.gov.in> website on date and time given below.
3. Summary of the tender notice is as follows :

Tender Reference No.	TN-03/2026-27
Tender Fee (Non-Refundable)	Rs. 2,50,000/- (Two Lakh Fifty Thousand)
Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) (Refundable)	Rs.4,10,900/- (Four Lakh Ten Thousand Nine Hundred)
Availability of tender documents (RFP) on websites	http://mahatenders.gov.in
Documents download and Bid Submission start date	Date 18/05/2026 At 11.00 am
Date & place for Pre-bid Conference	Date 25/05/2026 at 12:00 PM through virtual mode. Video call link: https://meet.google.com/ena-pabn-yuk
Documents download and Bid submission closing date	Date 01/06/2026 At 17.00 pm
Bid opening date (Technical Bid)	Date 02/06/2026 At 12.00 pm

4. The above-mentioned schedule of event(s) may be changed, at the discretion of Dy. Director (Buffer), T.A.T.R. Chandrapur without assigning any reason therefor.
5. The Dy. Director (Buffer), T.A.T.R. Chandrapur officer reserves the right to accept or reject any all proposals without assigning any reason whatsoever and also reserve the right to make suitable changes in tender notice, if needed.

Sign/-
(Lt. Kushagra Pathak)
Deputy Director (Buffer),
T.A.T.R. Chandrapur

DGIPR/2026/2027/840

SYMBOLIC POSSESSION NOTICE
ICICI Bank
Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi-110005
The undersigned being the Authorised Officer of ICICI Bank Limited under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13 (12) R/w Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) rules 2002, issued demand notices upon the borrowers mentioned below, (on the underlying pool assigned to ICICI Bank by Dewan Housing Finance Ltd.) in relation to the enforcement of security with respect to a Housing Loan facility granted, pursuant to a loan agreement entered into between DHFL and the borrower, to repay the amount mentioned in the notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice.
As the borrower failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described herein below in the exercise of powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of ICICI Bank Limited.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrower(s) (DHFL Old LAN & ICICI New LAN)	Description of Property/ Date of possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (₹)	Name of Branch
1.	Divya Gupta/ Kalpana Gupta/ (27300000332/ QZ8DWA00005014057) D-78, D Block, Mansarampark, Uttamnagar, Nr Metro Pillor No. 761, Delhi-110059	Property Bearing No. 66-A (A-66-A), Upper Ground Floor, Without Roof Rights, Out of Kharsa No.159, Situated At Village Bindapur Colony Known As A-Block, Sis Ram Park, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi- 110059 (With One 2 Wheeler Parking Space On The Stilt Floor)/ May 15, 2026	January 14, 2026 Rs. 22,26,186/-	Delhi Ncr

The above-mentioned borrowers(s)/ guarantor(s) are hereby given a 30 day notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold on the expiry of 30 days from the date of publication of this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.
Date : May 19, 2026 Place : Delhi/ Ncr
Authorized Officer, ICICI Bank Limited

EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE
Tender Notice No. : 09-MC-ROH-BOBRN-25-26-B, Dhanbad, dated : 14.05.2026
E-Open Tender in **Single Packet System** is invited in IREPS Portal for execution of the following work by Sr. Divisional Mechanical Engineer (Co-ord.), East Central Railway, Dhanbad:
1. Name of work : Outsourcing of Routine Overhauling (ROH) maintenance of BOBRN wagons at ROH Shed, BRWD.
2. Contract Period : 24 Months.
3. Location of work : ROH shed, BRWD.
4. Advertised Tender Value : ₹9,27,36,756/- (Rupees Nine Crore Twenty Seven Lakhs Thirty Six Thousand Seven Hundred Fifty Six Only).
5. Cost of Tender money : ₹0.00 (Nil).
6. Earnest money (As per Nit) to be deposited : ₹18,54,700/- (Rupees Eighteen Lakh Fifty Four Thousand Seven Hundred Only).
7. Tender Publishing Date: 14.05.2026
8. Date & time for submission of E-Tender : From 22.05.2026 to 05.06.2026 up to 11:30 hrs.
9. Date & time of opening of E-Tender : 05.06.2026 at 12.00 hrs.
10. Website particulars : <http://www.irops.gov.in> (No manual tender will be accepted against e-tendering.)
Sr. Divisional Mech. Engineer (Co-ord.) ECR/Dhanbad
PR/0242/DHN/Mech./T/25-26/40

CLIX HOUSING FINANCE PVT. LTD.
Registered Office: W2/14, 1st Floor, West Patel Nagar, Delhi, 110008
"APPENDIX-IV-A" [See proviso to rule 8(6)] Sale notice for sale of Immovable Properties
E-Auction Sale Notice for Sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.
Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described Immovable property mortgaged / charged to the CLIX Capital Services Pvt. Ltd. (CLIX) (Secured Creditors), the possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of CLIX Capital Services Pvt. Ltd. (CLIX), Secured Creditor, will be sold on "As is where is", "As is what is" and "Whatever there is" basis on 30.05.2026, for recovery of amount as mentioned below by due to the Secured Creditors from following Borrower(s), Guarantor(s) and Corporate Guarantor(s). The reserve price and earnest money to be deposited is mentioned below respectively.

Name of Borrower, Co-Borrower/ Guarantor(s) with addresses	Description & Owner(s) of Properties
1. Mrs. Laxmi Devi W/O Krishan Kumar Sharma, 2. Mr. Rohit Sharma S/O Krishan Kumar Sharma, Both R/O 3/542 Gurana Road, Gali No. 14 Baraut Baraut Po Baraut Dist Baghatpatt Uttarakhand 250611, Also At: Ward No. 1, Baraut, Near Saral Road, Sides Of The Road) Within The Boundary Of Municipal Council Baraut Baraut Po Baraut Dist Baghatpatt Uttarakhand 250611, Also At: Pargana And Tehsil Baraut District Bagpat, Admeasuring 33.45 Sq. Mtrs, Property In Nagar Palika Barui, Gurana Road Baraut Bagpat U.P. (First Floor Coverage 33.45 Sq Mtrs, Second Floor Coverage 18.58 Sq. 250611. Loan No. - SNOHLM0000707982, (Along with future Mtrs.), Bounded As Under: East: House Of Atul Sharma, West: The Pathi Interest and charges accruing after 14.10.2025 till the total Of 8 Feet Wide, North: 40 Feet Road, South: House Of Mrs. Rajan Devi realization of the loan amount)	All That Piece And Parcels Of The Residential Property Situated At Baraut Mohalla, Basant Vihar Gurana, Gali No. 05 (From Sangami Cinema To Lord Mahavira School On Gurana Road, Entire Area On Both Sides Of The Road) Within The Boundary Of Municipal Council Baraut Baraut Po Baraut Dist Baghatpatt Uttarakhand 250611, Also At: Pargana And Tehsil Baraut District Bagpat, Admeasuring 33.45 Sq. Mtrs, Property In Nagar Palika Barui, Gurana Road Baraut Bagpat U.P. (First Floor Coverage 33.45 Sq Mtrs, Second Floor Coverage 18.58 Sq. 250611. Loan No. - SNOHLM0000707982, (Along with future Mtrs.), Bounded As Under: East: House Of Atul Sharma, West: The Pathi Interest and charges accruing after 14.10.2025 till the total Of 8 Feet Wide, North: 40 Feet Road, South: House Of Mrs. Rajan Devi realization of the loan amount)

Reserve Price (RP) & EMD & Incremental Amount	Recovery Amount as per Demand Notice	Date & Time of On-Site Inspection of Property	Date & Time of E-Auction
Rs. 28,35,000/-, Rs. 2,83,500/-, Rs. 1,00,000/-	Rs. 22,13,159.36/- as on 14.10.2025	28.05.2026 to 29.05.2026 From 10.00 AM to 5.00 PM	30.05.2026 11 Am to 1 Pm (with unlimited extensions of 5 Minutes each)

EMD amount shall be remitted through NEFT/RTGS/Funds Transfer in favor of "CLIX Capital Services Pvt. Ltd.", Account No. 3419500065, CICI/BANK, IFSC: ICIC003419500065, CLIX Capital Services Pvt. Ltd., 1st Floor, West Patel Nagar, Delhi, 110008.
Last date for deposit of EMD and uploading Bid documents: 29-05-2026 Till 12.00 PM at www.bankauctions.in
The balance 25% of final purchase price minus EMD amount shall be deposited by the successful bidder, latest by the next working day by way of RTGS / NEFT in the E-Auction account of CLIX, as detailed above. The balance 75% of the final purchase shall be deposited by way of RTGS / NEFT within 15 days from the date of auction in the same E-Auction account as above. The refund of EMD to the successful bidder shall be made only in the account number mentioned by due to the Secured Creditors from following Borrower(s), Guarantor(s) and Corporate Guarantor(s).
Terms and Conditions:- E-auction is being held on "AS IS WHERE IS" and "AS IS WHAT IS" and "WHATEVER THERE IS" basis and will be conducted "Online". The auction will be conducted through CLIX's approved service provider C1 India Pvt. Ltd. at the web portal www.bankauctions.in. Bid Documents, Declaration, General Terms and Conditions of online auction sale are available in www.bankauctions.in. To the best of knowledge and information of the Authorized Officer, there is no encumbrance on the properties. However, the intending bidders should make their own independent inquiries regarding the encumbrances, title of properties put on auction and claims/rights / dues/ affecting the properties, prior to submitting their bid. In this regard, the e-Auction advertisement does not constitute and will not be deemed to constitute any representation of CLIX. For any details with respect to any help, procedure and online training in respect of the auction process please contact +91-7291981124/25/26 and E-mail ID - delhi@clixindia.com. For any details regarding the property please contact Mr. Ayush Gupta, (M) 9999916811. It may please be noted that in case of any discrepancy/ inconsistency between English and in Hindi then the Hindi then the content of the notice published in English shall prevail. The Authorised Officer/ Secured Creditor shall not be responsible in anyway for any third party claims/ rights/ dues. The sale shall be subject to rules/ conditions prescribed under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002. **STATUTORY 15 DAYS SALE NOTICE UNDER THE SARFAESI ACT, 2002**
Date : 19.05.2026, Place : Bagpat
Authorized Officer, CLIX Capital Services Pvt. Ltd.

वरिय पुलिस अधीक्षक का कार्यालय पूर्वी सिंहभूम, जमशेदपुर
लापता: आवश्यक सूचना
गुमशुदा महिला शीला देवी, उम्र-करीब 53 वर्ष।
सर्व साधारण को सूचित करना है कि गुमशुदा शीला देवी, उम्र-करीब 53 वर्ष, पति-योगेन्द्र प्रसाद, पता-नियर जी08070ल0 चर्च, रोड नं0-04, जवाहर नगर, थाना-मानगो, जिला-पूर्वी सिंहभूम, जमशेदपुर जो दिनांक-05.05.2026 को संस्था समय करीब 04:05 बजे घर से निकली है जो तक वापस नहीं लौटी है। आवेदक एवं इनके परिवारवालों ने अपने स्तर से काफी खोजबीन किया परन्तु कुछ पता नहीं चल सका। गुमशुदा लड़की का हलिना निम्न प्रकार है :- उम्र-करीब 53 वर्ष, रंग-गोरा, ऊँचाई-04 फीट 03 इंच, बाल-काला एवं सफेद, पहनावा-हरा रंग का साड़ी, पैर में चप्पल, भाषा-हिन्दी, भोजपुरी एवं बंगला।
अतः आप सभी जन साधारण से अनुरोध है कि उपरोक्त गुमशुदा के संबंध में किसी प्रकार की जानकारी प्राप्त होती है तो इसकी सूचना वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक, पूर्वी सिंहभूम, जमशेदपुर के कार्यालय में निम्नांकित फोन नम्बर पर सूचित करें।
वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक, पूर्वी सिंहभूम, जमशेदपुर : 0657-2431006
पुलिस अधीक्षक (नगर), पूर्वी सिंहभूम, जमशेदपुर : 9471190203
पुलिस उपाधीक्षक, (मु0-01) : 9431706481
थाना प्रभारी, मानगो : 9431706488
वरीय पुलिस अधीक्षक, पूर्वी सिंहभूम, जमशेदपुर

PR 380129 Police(26-27)#D
POLICE HELPLINE (EMERGENCY DIAL)-112
WOMEN HELPLINE-1091
CYBER CRIME HELPLINE-1930
CHILD HELPLINE-1098
DOMESTIC ABUSE HELPLINE-181
AMBULANCE SERVICE-108

The South Indian Bank Ltd
Regional Office-Delhi, 3rd Floor, Plot No.21, 21/1, Pusa Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi -110005
Phone-011 4233 1664/011 4512 8661
Email-ro1008@sib.co.in
Ref: DEL/CRD/SAR/11/2026-27 Date: 18-05-2026
E - AUCTION SALE NOTICE
E-Auction Sale Notice for Sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) and 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.
1. M/s. Shri Gangadas Textile Industries Limited, 7098 Shop No. 1, Jain Market, Guru Nanak Gali, Gandhi Nagar, Delhi- 110 031. Also at: F 224, Focal Point, Phase VIII, Chandigarh Road, Ludhiana, Punjab 141 010. Also at: Ground & First Floor, Property No. 465, Near Sabzi Mandi, Jheel Khurana, Delhi 110 051
2. M/S GG Fabrics under proprietorship of Mr. Nitin Dawar at F 224, Focal Point, Phase VIII, Chandigarh Road, Ludhiana Punjab-141 010
3. Mr. Pankaj Ahuja 4181, 04 Duragpur Halibawal, Kalan, Ludhiana, Punjab- 141 001
4. Mrs. Hema Ahuja 4181, 04 Duragpur Halibawal, Kalan, Ludhiana, Punjab 141 001
5. Mr. Rakesh Kumar 74/2, Ram Nagar Extension, Krishna Nagar, Delhi 110 051
6. Mr. Suresh Kumar 74/2, Ram Nagar Extension, Krishna Nagar, Delhi 110 051
7. Mr. Vinay Dawar House No. 267, Block A, Rajguru Nagar, Ludhiana, Punjab 141 012
8. Mr. Nitin Dawar, House No. 267, Block A, Rajguru Nagar, Ludhiana, Punjab 141 012 (Personal guarantor and legal heir of late Ramesh Kumar).
9. Mrs. Shivani Kochar, 74/2, Ram Nagar Extension, Krishna Nagar, Delhi 110 051, also at, House No. 267, Block A, Rajguru Nagar, Ludhiana, Punjab 141 012. (Legal heir of late Ramesh Kumar)
10. Mrs. Savita Dawar, House No. 267, Block A, Rajguru Nagar, Ludhiana, Punjab 141 012, also at, House No. 504, Block GX, BRN Nagar Extension, Opposite Verka Milk Plant, Ferozpur Road, Ludhiana-141 012, also at 74/2, Ram Nagar Extension, Krishna Nagar, Delhi-110051
Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the borrower/guarantor/Legal heirs that the below described immovable properties mortgaged to the South Indian Bank Ltd, Branch Vasundhara (Secured Creditor), the Physical Possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of The South Indian Bank Limited (Secured Creditor), will be sold on "as is where is" basis, "as is what is" and "whatever there is" condition on 04-06-2026 for recovery of an amount of Rs. 16,92,38,143.26/- (Rupees Sixteen Crore Ninety Two Lakh Thirty Eight Thousand One Hundred Forty Three and Twenty Six Paise Only) as on 18-02-2026, with future interest, costs and expenses etc. thereon due to The South Indian Bank Limited, Branch Vasundhara (Secured Creditor), from the above mentioned Borrower(s) and guarantor(s).
Item No.1

Name of Property Owner	Late Mr. Ramesh Kumar (Now represented by legal heirs Mrs. Savita Dawar, Mr. Vinay Dawar, Mr. Nitin Dawar and Mrs. Shivani Kochar), Mr. Rakesh Kumar and Mr. Suresh Kumar.
Description of property	All that Part and Parcel of Freehold Residential Property admeasuring 50 square yards out of area measuring 100 sq. yds. out of total area measuring 218 sq. yds. out of Kharsa No. 464/362 along with Residential Buildings constructed upon it bearing No. MPL 783/18-A/5 (old), New No. IX/7172 along with all other constructions, improvements, Easementary Rights existing and appurtenant thereon situated at Gaur Nanak Gali, Gandhi Nagar, Village Seelampur, Illaga Shadara, Delhi 110 031 owned by Late Ramesh Kumar Dawar (since expired and represented by his legal heirs; Mrs. Savita Dawar, Mr. Vinay Dawar, Mr. Nitin Dawar and Mrs. Shivani Kochar), Mr. Rakesh Kumar and Mr. Suresh Kumar more particularly described under Sale Deed No. 1287 dated 09-05-1989 at SRO -IV, New Delhi/Delhi and Will dated 02-06-1997 bounded on North by Common Passage, South by Other's property, East by Common wall & Shop No. 7 and west by common wall and shop No.5
Reserve Price (Item No.1)	Rs. 1,44,50,000/- (Rupees One Crore Forty Four Lakh Fifty Thousand Only)
Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) (Item No.1)	Rs. 14,45,000/- (Rupees Fourteen Lakhs Forty Five Thousand Only) EMD shall be deposited on or before 03.06.2026 till 02.00 PM
Bid Increment amount Item No.1	Rs. 10,000/- (Rupees Ten Thousand Only)
Date and time of E-auction Item No.1	04.06.2026 from 11:00 AM to 11:30 AM (with 5 minute unlimited auto extensions till sale is concluded)
Encumbrances known to the Bank (Item No.1)	Nil/ Encumbrances from 01.01.2018 to 22.11.2022

For detailed terms and conditions of the sale, please refer to the link provided in web portal of South Indian Bank Ltd, (Secured Creditor) website i.e. www.southindianbank.com. Details also available at <https://bankauctions.in>.
For any further clarification with regards to inspection of property, terms and conditions of the e-auction or submission of bids, kindly contact South Indian Bank Ltd on 9818-772-322 /7309-655-552 /9007-046-006 (contact number).
Sd/- AUTHORISED OFFICER

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023
Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused Ravi Thapa, S/o: Lt. Rakesh Thapa, R/o: H.No. 24, Gali No. 10, C-Block, Bhajanpura, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No. 357/2020 U/s 129/55 Gambling Act, P.S.: Subzi Mandi, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Ravi Thapa cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Ravi Thapa has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said Ravi Thapa accused of offence in case FIR No. 357/2020 U/s 129/55 Gambling Act, P.S.: Subzi Mandi, Delhi and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 30.07.2026.
By Order
Ms. Preeti Rajoria
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07 (Central)
Room No. 32, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C.
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person (1) Vishal Rao @ Kaku, S/o: Sh. Kishan Rao, (2) Ranjeet, S/o: Sh. Lal Chand, R/o: H.No. 66, Gali No. 3, Jharoda Majra, Burari, Delhi (3) Ajeet Sehrawat, S/o: Sh. Jaijir Singh, R/o: Village Nayan, Tehsil District Hissar, Haryana, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in FIR No. 389/2019 U/S: 392/394/397/411/120B/34 IPC & 25/54/59 Arms ACT, PS: Mukherjee Nagar, Delhi, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) (1) Vishal Rao @ Kaku (2) Ranjeet (3) Ajeet Sehrawat, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) (1) Vishal Rao @ Kaku (2) Ranjeet (3) Ajeet Sehrawat, has absconded (or is concealing themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person (1) Vishal Rao @ Kaku (2) Ranjeet (3) Ajeet Sehrawat, of FIR No. 389/2019 U/S: 392/394/397/411/120B/ 34 IPC & 25/54/59 Arms ACT, PS: Mukherjee Nagar, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 09.07.2026.
By Order
Vandana
Additional Sessions Judge-02 (North)
Room No. 202, 2nd Floor
District Court Rohini, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person (1) Vishal Rao @ Kaku, S/o: Sh. Kishan Rao, (2) Ranjeet, S/o: Sh. Lal Chand, R/o: H.No. 66, Gali No. 3, Jharoda Majra, Burari, Delhi (3) Ajeet Sehrawat, S/o: Sh. Jaijir Singh, R/o: Village Nayan, Tehsil District Hissar, Haryana, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in FIR No. 389/2019 U/S: 392/394/397/411/120B/34 IPC & 25/54/59 Arms ACT, PS: Mukherjee Nagar, Delhi, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) (1) Vishal Rao @ Kaku (2) Ranjeet (3) Ajeet Sehrawat, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) (1) Vishal Rao @ Kaku (2) Ranjeet (3) Ajeet Sehrawat, has absconded (or is concealing themselves to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person (1) Vishal Rao @ Kaku (2) Ranjeet (3) Ajeet Sehrawat, of FIR No. 389/2019 U/S: 392/394/397/411/120B/ 34 IPC & 25/54/59 Arms ACT, PS: Mukherjee Nagar, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 09.07.2026.
By Order
Vandana
Additional Sessions Judge-02 (North)
Room No. 202, 2nd Floor
District Court Rohini, Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023
Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely Rafiqul @Jony S/o Sheikh Raja Ali R/o H-38/ C-154 Juggi ICD Park, Jahangirpuri, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in FIR No. 413/21 U/s 379/411/34 IPC PS: Mukherjee Nagar, Delhi, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Rafiqul @Jony cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Rafiqul @Jony has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said Rafiqul @Jony accused of FIR No. 413/21 U/s 379/411/34 IPC PS: Mukherjee Nagar, Delhi, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 10.07.2026.
By Order
Ms. Ardeep Kaur
ACJM (N), Room No. 117
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/6453/NW/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Safikul Mian @ Raju S/o Azizul Mian R/o F-9, Vijay Vihar Phase-II, Delhi also at: Paschim Sitalkuchi, P.S. Sitalkuchi, Distt. Cooch Behar, West Bengal has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence FIR No. 19/2018 u/s 324/34 IPC at P.S. Vijay Vihar, Distt. Rohini, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said Safikul Mian @ Raju cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said Safikul Mian @ Raju has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said Safikul Mian @ Raju accused of FIR No. 19/2018 u/s 324/34 IPC at P.S. Vijay Vihar, Distt. Rohini, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on 30.06.2026.
By Order: Ms. Shagun,
Judicial Magistrate, First Class,
North-West Court No. 109, First Floor,
Rohini Courts, Delhi.

DP/6354/RD/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023
Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Ramesh, S/o: Lt. Ajit Singh, R/o: F-159, Gali No. 2, Aman Vihar, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case FIR No. 488/2018, U/s 33 Delhi Excise Act, P.S.: Aman Vihar, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused Ramesh cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused Ramesh has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).
Proclamation is hereby made that the said Ramesh accused of offence in case FIR No. 488/2018, U/s 33 Delhi Excise Act, P.S.: Aman Vihar, Delhi and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before 01.07.2026.
By Order
Ms. Shagun
Judicial Magistrate First Class-06
Room No. 109, Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/6423/RD/2026
(Court Matter)

UJVN Limited
H.O.: "UJJAWAL", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, Dhradhun-248006
Telephone: 0135-2763808; Fax: 0135- 2763508
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866, Website : www.ujvn.com
RO No. 425 Dated : 18/05/2026
SHORT TERM E-TENDER NOTICE
Office of the Executive Engineer (Civil-SHP), UJVN Ltd., Hat, Dharchula, Pithoragarh, invites online bids from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:
Tender No. : 02/EE (Civil-SHP)/Dharchula/2026-27.
Name of Work : "Division of forest land for Painagad SHP (15 MW) including preparation of Forest Clearance proposal, obtaining all requisite consents from Gram Pradhans / Panchayats / Nagar Palika and all concerned Central / State Departments and facilitating grant of Stage-I and Stage-II Forest Clearance to UJVN Ltd."
Estimated Costs: Rs. 31,15,00,00,00 + GST Extra as applicable (Rupees Thirty One Lak Fifteen Thousand Only) excluding GST
Date of availability of bid Document on website: From 17.00 hrs of 18.05.2026
Last Date for submission of Tender: Upto to 17.00 hrs of 04.06.2026
For fuller & further details, kindly visit e-procurement portal <http://uktenders.gov.in>
Executive Engineer (Civil-SHP)
"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

CLIX HOUSING FINANCE LIMITED
NOTICE UNDER SECTION 13(2) OF THE SECURITIZATION AND RECONSTRUCTION OF FINANCIAL ASSETS AND ENFORCEMENT OF SECURITY INTEREST ACT, 2002
The undersigned being the Authorised Officer of CLIX Housing Finance Limited, a Housing Finance Company under the National Housing Bank Act under the provision of the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (54 of 2002) (hereinafter referred to as "SARFESI Act, 2002") having its Registered Office: W2/14, 1st Floor, West Patel Nagar, Delhi, 110008 (hereinafter referred to as "CLIX"), and is engaged in the business of providing financial assistance to meet the needs of over millions of its customers all over India, hereby issues to you the following notice :-

Name & Address Of Borrower/Co-Borrower : 1. Mukesh Kumar Gupta S/O Tara Chand Gupta, 2. Sanju Goel S/O Mukesh Chand Gupta, 3. Mohini Devi W/O Tara Chand Gupta, All At - A-13, Molartand Village, Near Pipal Wala Shani Mandir, Badarpur, Delhi-110044, Sr.No. 1, Aisa At - H-1, No. 85, Ground Floor, Kh. No. 166/2 Village Tajpur, Badarpur, Delhi-110044, 4. Shiksha Arora D/O Sanjay Arora, Property No. 89, 2nd Floor, Ignou Road, New Sarai, New Delhi-110088. Also At: Geopact India Pvt. Ltd., Sec-18, Plot No. 22, Gurugram, Haryana- 122002. Also At: A-1/3, Molartand Village, Near Pipal Wala Shani Mandir, Badarpur, Delhi-110044.
Loan A/C Number: AC2020091463836, Loan Amount Availed /Date : Rs.74,36,600/- / 27.11.2

Huma gets candid about her Cannes DREAMS

Qureshi credited Aishwarya Rai Bachchan for making the film festival ‘important’ in India

Actress and producer Huma Qureshi made her big return to the Cannes Film Festival over the weekend, where she appeared at the Red Sea Film Foundation’s ‘Women in Cinema’ gala. The actress, who also made jaw-dropping appearances on the red carpet, got candid about her Cannes dreams.

Speaking during a conversation with Sucharita Tyagi, Huma reflected on her journey at the prestigious festival, which began with ‘Gangs of Wasseyapur’. Over the years, she has returned to Cannes with multiple projects and this time attended the festival as a producer. Recalling how Aishwarya Rai Bachchan’s Cannes appearances left a lasting impression on her, Huma said, “I used to watch Aishwarya coming over here and

doing her red carpet moments. I swear, ever since that, I was like ‘I want to do this once’.”

The actor, who dressed in an elegant saree, quipped that her look paid tribute to Ash’s iconic appearance from the ‘Devdas’ premiere with

Huma reflected on her journey at the prestigious festival, which began with ‘Gangs of Wasseyapur’

Shah Rukh Khan and Sanjay Leela Bhansali. “My saree look is a homage to her ‘Devdas’ look,” Huma said, before jokingly adding, “I just made that up right now.”

Praising the Bollywood

star’s long-standing association with Cannes, Huma added, “She’s (Aishwarya) really sort of made these festivals so important.”

During the conversation, she was asked about bringing films to festivals as a producer, contrary to current trends of filmmakers backing out of festivals over fears of negative reviews hampering the box office opening. Huma said, “In a time like this, in a world that we live in, where everything is so dependent on the algorithm working or whatever the understanding is, I feel like film festivals like this are so important.”

Describing the cultural value of global cinema events, she continued, “This is nuanced, geographically, filmmaking at its finest where you have emotionally evocative stories that cut across barriers.”

AGENCIES

Sonakshi is the Meryl Streep of our country: Ashwiny Iyer Tiwari

OUR CORRESPONDENT

With conversations around justice, privilege and moral conflict becoming increasingly more relevant than ever, ‘System’ is a courtroom drama that pushes into uncomfortable questions about who gets to define truth. The movie is set to bring a layered and emotionally charged narrative that explores how power can shape the truth depending on who holds it. Directed by Ashwiny Iyer Tiwari of ‘Nil Battey Sannata’ fame, the story follows Neha, a determined young lawyer played by Sonakshi Sinha, as she navigates a world where influence often outweighs justice and where every decision carries emotional and ethical weight.

“Despite coming from a film background and having witnessed both privilege and struggle closely, Sonakshi is very comfortable with her own skin self, right now. She is genuinely not affected by the noise around her anymore. I



The director teams up with the ‘Dabangg’ actress in upcoming courtroom drama ‘System’

often tell her she is the Meryl Streep and the Kate Winslet of our country. When you have seen both sides of life, you start reading people differently. I

think that reflects in the kind of choices she makes as an actor. She is naturally empathetic. And I also feel she does not carry her father’s legacy as a weight, which says a lot about her clarity,” said Tiwari.

The filmmaker also revealed how even the smallest details became an extension of Sonakshi’s character in the story. “Throughout the film, Sonakshi wears grey nail paint. I had been thinking for months about what Sonakshi’s nail colour would be. She is the type to do extensions. Then, while browsing, I found a grey nail paint which was the emotion I wanted. I told her to wear it as a kind of character detail and she readily agreed. The reason I wanted her to wear it was that I felt she was someone who would always have dark nail paint. For me, that grey colour was important,” the ‘Bareilly Ki Barfi’ director said.

‘System’ also boasts a stellar cast featuring Jyotika and Ashutosh Gowariker in pivotal roles and will start streaming on ‘Prime Video’ on May 22.



Rebuilding strength, redefining motherhood



JAI TALWAR

Award-winning women’s health expert Sucheta Pal is presently on her ‘Rani Tour’, India’s first active mothers’ fitness and wellness festival, taking her ‘Mom.Bod.Strong’ program to create a dedicated space for women to focus on recovery, strength and holistic wellbeing across five cities. Designed for today’s mothers balancing health, identity and ambition, the tour has covered Mumbai, Hyderabad and Bengaluru and will soon cover Ahmedabad on May 23 and New Delhi on June 12.

She is the first Indian to attain the position of Global Brand Ambassador for India as the master trainer in Zumba

Award-winning women’s health expert Sucheta Pal is presently on her ‘Rani Tour’

sador for India as the master trainer in Zumba. After training and teaching in the United States, this engineer turned celebrity fitness trainer returned to the country in 2012 and is now the lead Zumba Education Specialist & Global Brand Ambassador and an International presenter. Her passion has inspired an entire nation to courageously pursue alternate careers and in 2018, the Ministry of Women and Child Development felicitated her along with 112 women achievers.

Building on the success of her ‘Mom.Bod.Strong’ program, the ‘Rani Tour’ brings together a curated, science-backed approach to maternal fitness, an area that continues to be largely overlooked in India. Through immersive, on-ground experiences, the initiative aims to shift the narrative from ‘bouncing back’ to rebuilding strength from within. Sucheta Pal said, “We’ve reduced post-baby fitness to a before-and-after photo. But real recovery is internal because motherhood changes you biologically - your core, your hormones and your nervous system. That’s the strength we’re rebuilding.”

Female gaze gave ‘TOXIC’ a fresh emotional texture: Yash

The South Indian superstar has consistently pushed boundaries with his choice of cinema

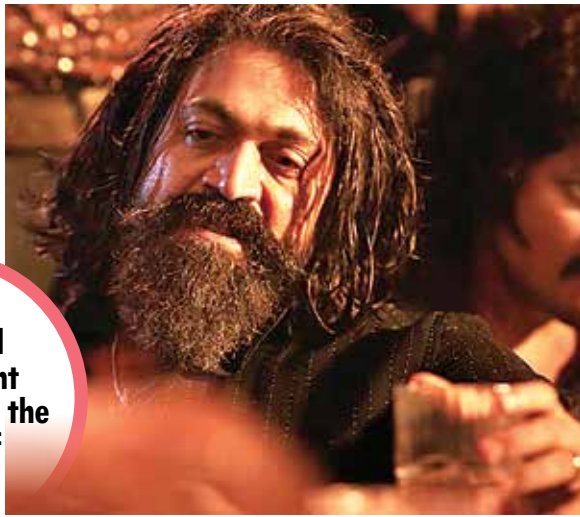
OUR CORRESPONDENT

South Indian superstar Yash has consistently pushed boundaries with his choice of cinema, and with his upcoming film ‘Toxic: A Fairy Tale for Grown-Ups’, he believes audiences are set to witness something emotionally fresh and layered. While the film has already generated massive anticipation for its scale and gritty world, Yash recently revealed that what truly sets the project apart is director Geetu Mohandas’ unique perspective and storytelling approach.

During a recent interaction with ‘Variety’, Yash opened up about collaborating with Geetu Mohandas and explained how her female gaze brought an entirely different emotional texture to the film. According to the actor, the filmmaker’s perspective added depth to everything from violence and romance. “Fundamentally, it becomes very different. It’s coming from a female gaze. We see life differently; we see things differently.

Every emotion or action is perceived according to your belief system and thoughts. There’s always a different point of view when women look at things. We

He even addressed the constant deferment of the release of the film



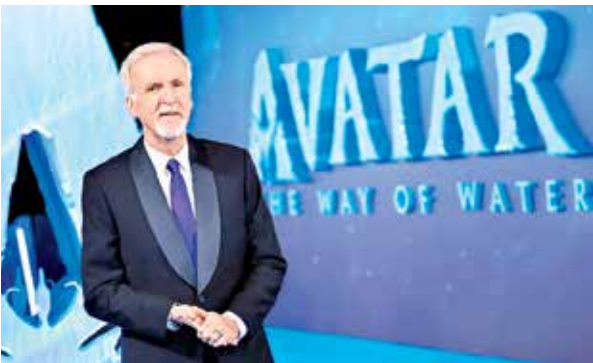
miss out on a lot of emotions or things that may not matter to us but may matter deeply to them. So

that perspective becomes so refreshing, layered and deep,” said Yash. Ever since the project

was announced, the film has remained one of the most talked-about upcoming pan-India ventures. However, the film’s release has been postponed on multiple occasions. Initially, the film was supposed to hit theatres on March 19. But the release was pushed back due to the war in the Middle East. Later, the makers decided to release the film in the first week of June, but it has now been pushed as well.

Yash even addressed the constant deferment of the release of the film. “That is really something my fans or people in India will not like. They’ll be upset because culturally, once you start shooting the film, there is a timeline in their head,” Yash told ‘Variety’.

‘AVATAR 4 and 5 are still floating out there’



LOS ANGELES: Oscar-winning filmmaker James Cameron said the fourth and fifth instalments of his acclaimed ‘Avatar’ franchise are ‘still floating’ and he wants to use new technologies to make films efficiently.

Cameron introduced the franchise in 2009, which was followed by another instalment, ‘Avatar: The Way of Water’ in 2022 and ‘Avatar: Fire and Ash’ in 2025. “I’ll be doing some writing, I’ve got a number of projects I’m cooking. And ‘Avatar 4 and 5 are still floating out there,” Cameron said on ‘The Empire Film Podcast’.

He added, “We’re gonna be looking at some new tech-

nologies to try and do them more efficiently, because they’re hideously expensive and take a long time. I want to do them in half the time for two-thirds of the cost, that’s my metric. And so, it’s going to take us a year or so to figure out how to do that. And in the meantime, I’ll be writing and probably be doing a couple of other things.”

‘Avatar’ followed Jake Sully (Sam Worthington), who becomes an unlikely champion for the Na’vi, the 10-foot-tall and blue-skinned, sapient humanoid, in their fight for survival.

‘Avatar 4’ and ‘Avatar 5’ are tentatively scheduled to release in theatres worldwide. PFI

Saif Ali Khan anchors this familiar hinterland drama

Though the screenplay lacks tension and emotional depth, Saif and Sanjay Mishra’s intense performances keep the film engaging

Film: **Kartavya**
Director: **Pulkit**
Cast: **Saif Ali Khan, Sanjay Mishra, Rasika Dugal, Zakir Hussain**

ANINDITA ACHARYA



Kartavya’ on ‘Netflix’ is set in a world that feels familiar. It is the violent, politically charged landscape of India’s hinterlands, where power struggles, blind faith, honour killings and rural politics shape everyday life. At the centre of this chaos is an upright police officer caught between social pressure and his own sense of duty.

A morally grounded cop battling crime, caste politics and a broken system is not new territory in Indian OTT. We have already seen similar worlds in ‘Paatal Lok’, ‘Bhaukaal’, ‘Kohrra’ and ‘Dahaad’. ‘Kartavya’ stays away from the larger-than-life ‘hero cop’ template and instead presents a more realistic setting where Saif Ali Khan’s Pawan is persistent, ethical and determined to fulfil his duty. The strong hinterland texture works in the film’s favour.

Like ‘Kartavya’, Pulkit’s previous film ‘Bhakshak’, starring Bhumi Pednekar, was also backed by Shah Rukh Khan’s ‘Red Chillies Entertainment’. With ‘Kartavya’, the director goes a step further by adding themes of honour killing and blind faith and Saif carries the film strongly on his shoulders. Pawan is introduced as a cop who loves wearing white sneakers, perhaps symbolic of his honesty. His life changes when a journalist is shot dead under his watch by ‘baalak’ Harpal, acting on the orders of Anand Shri, played by Saurabh Dwivedi. Anand Shri runs an organised crime network

while exploiting children in the name of faith. Yet the film’s larger conflict lies elsewhere. Pawan is also battling his own father, played by Zakir Hussain, who believes in honour killing and is determined to hunt down his younger son. Pawan’s fight is against both the system and his father, while trying to save his own son from falling into darkness.

‘Kartavya’ has all the ingredients of an intense thriller, but the screenplay never fully builds the tension the story demands. A film centred around honour killing should have carried greater emotional intensity, confront-

ation and dramatic heat, but much of that remains missing.

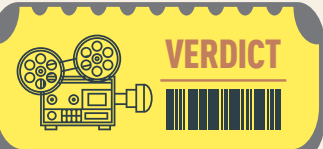
The biggest disappointment is Anand Shri. Saurabh Dwivedi is a recognisable journalist known for celebrity interviews, but acting clearly doesn’t come naturally to him. One wishes he had borrowed some inspiration from Bobby Deol in ‘Aashram’. Perhaps the makers were aware of the limitation because, despite being the main antagonist, he barely appears in the film.

The film truly belongs to Saif Ali Khan and Sanjay Mishra. Mishra, playing Pawan’s aide Ashok, once again

proves why he is among the finest actors working today. His eyes alone communicate more than pages of dialogue. Manish Chaudhary as senior inspector Keshav feels familiar and predictable, while Rasika Dugal efficiently supports the narrative as Pawan’s wife.

But it is Saif who makes Kartavya worth watching. Over the years, he has mastered several North Indian dialects in projects like ‘Omkaara’, ‘Sacred Games’, ‘Tandav’ and ‘Laal Kaptaan’ and his Haryanvi accent here feels natural and convincing. Some moments may remind viewers of Sartaj Singh from ‘Sacred Games’, but Saif still manages to bring freshness to Pawan. His confrontations with his father and Ashok are among the film’s strongest scenes. He once again proves that despite being a Nawab, he remains perhaps the only Khan constantly willing to experiment.

Pulkit sprinkles playful nods to Shah Rukh Khan and Amrish Puri across the film, liberties possible with SRK backing the project. Though slow and predictable, ‘Kartavya’ is lifted by strong performances from Saif and Mishra. The film is on ‘Netflix’.



KARTAVYA is a decent, slow and predictable watch, elevated by the performances of Saif Ali Khan and Sanjay Mishra